

Self Introduction

Jingwei Guo

Email: jingweiguo19@outlook.com

Homepage: jingweio.github.io

Basic Information

Alibaba Group

- Senior Algorithm Engineer in Taobao & Tmall Group
- Responsibilities: Advertisement Reranking System

Sep. 2024 - Present



University of Liverpool

- Ph.D. in CS & EE
- Advisors: Prof. Kaizhu Huang, Prof. Xinping Yi

Dec. 2019 - Jul. 2024



Kaizhu Huang

Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering at Duke Kunshan University
DKU Faculty
✉ kaizhu.huang@dukekunshan.edu.cn



Dr. Xinping Yi

Professor
National Mobile Communications Research Laboratory
Southeast University
Nanjing, China
Email: xyi at seu dot edu dot cn

Graph Learning Against Homophilous Assumptions

Jingwei Guo, et.al. Rethinking Spectral Graph Neural Networks with Spatially Adaptive Filtering. *TNNLS (Under 2nd Review) 2025*.

Jingwei Guo, et.al. ES-GNN: Generalizing Graph Neural Networks Beyond Homophily with Edge Splitting. *TPAMI 2024*.

Jingwei Guo, et.al. Graph Neural Networks with Diverse Spectral Filtering. *WWW 2023*.

Jingwei Guo, et.al. Learning Disentangled Graph Convolutional Networks Locally and Globally. *TNNLS 2022*.

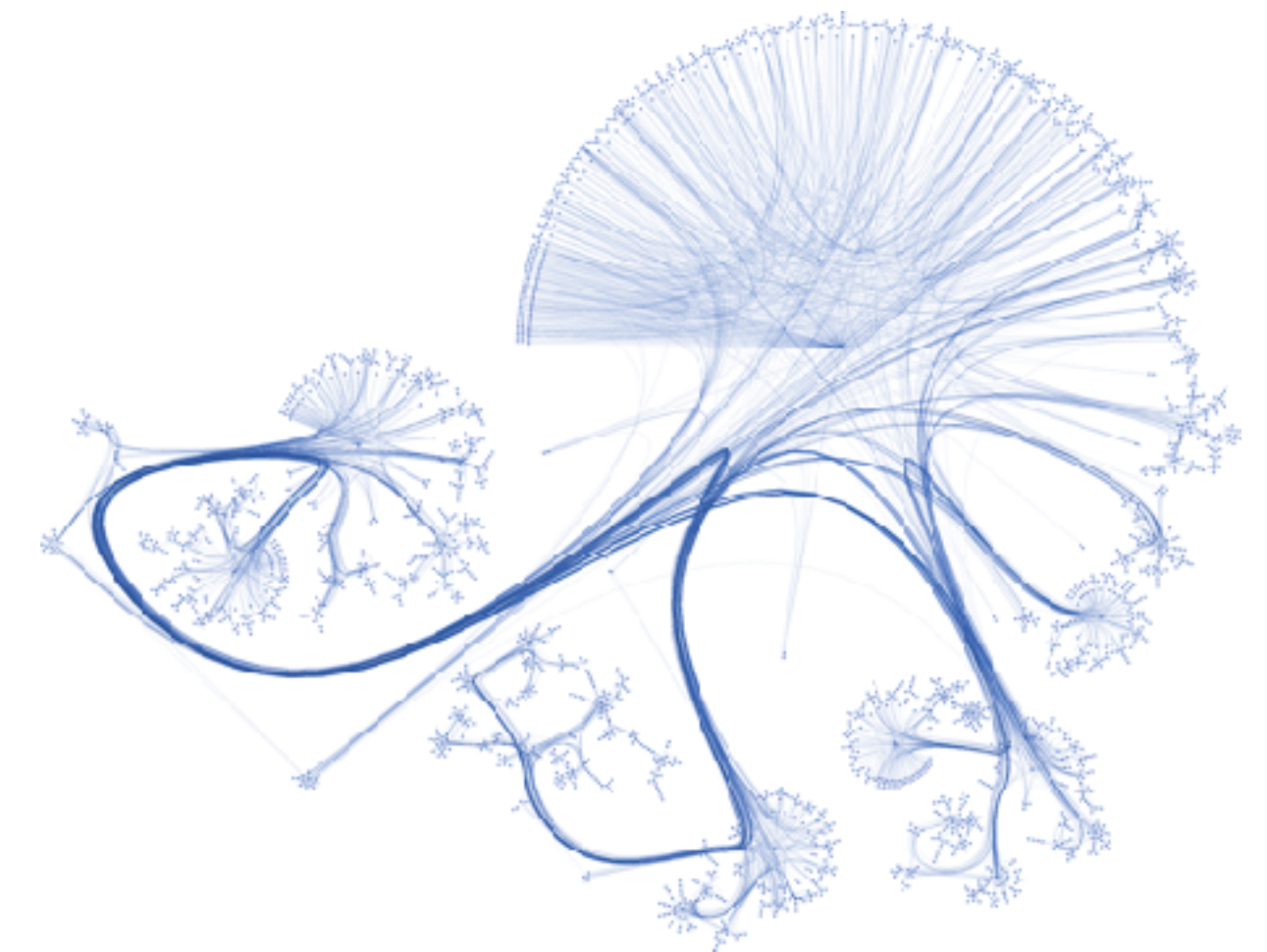
Transfer Learning Under Distribution Shifts

Zixian Su*, **Jingwei Guo***, et.al. Un-mixing Test-time Adaptation under Heterogeneous Data Streams. *TKDE (Under Review) 2025*.

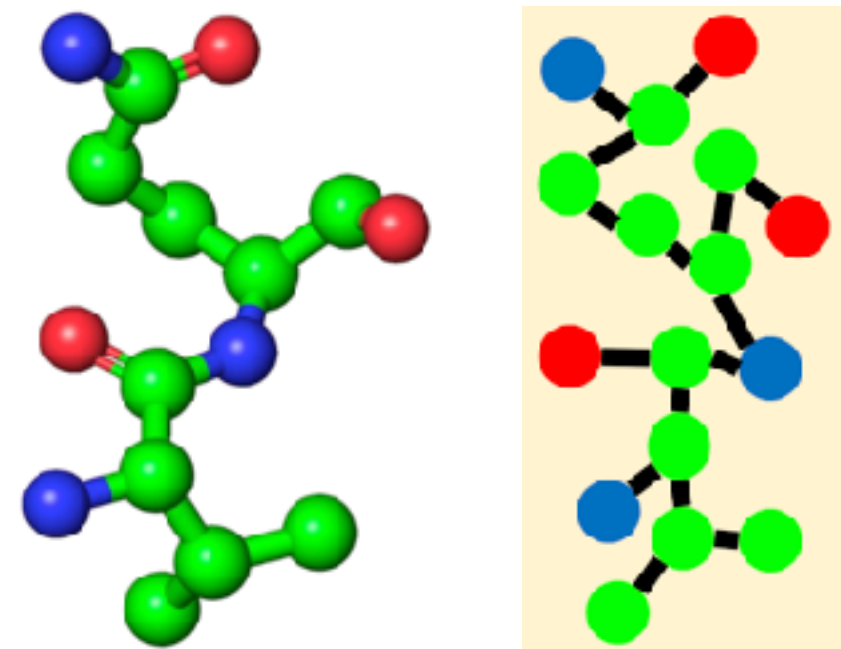
Zixian Su*, **Jingwei Guo***, et.al. Navigating Distribution Shifts in Medical Image Analysis. *ACM Comput. Surv (Under Review) 2025*.

Zixian Su, **Jingwei Guo**, et.al. Unraveling Batch Normalization for Realistic Test-Time Adaptation. *AAAI 2024*.

Graph Learning Against Homophilous Assumptions

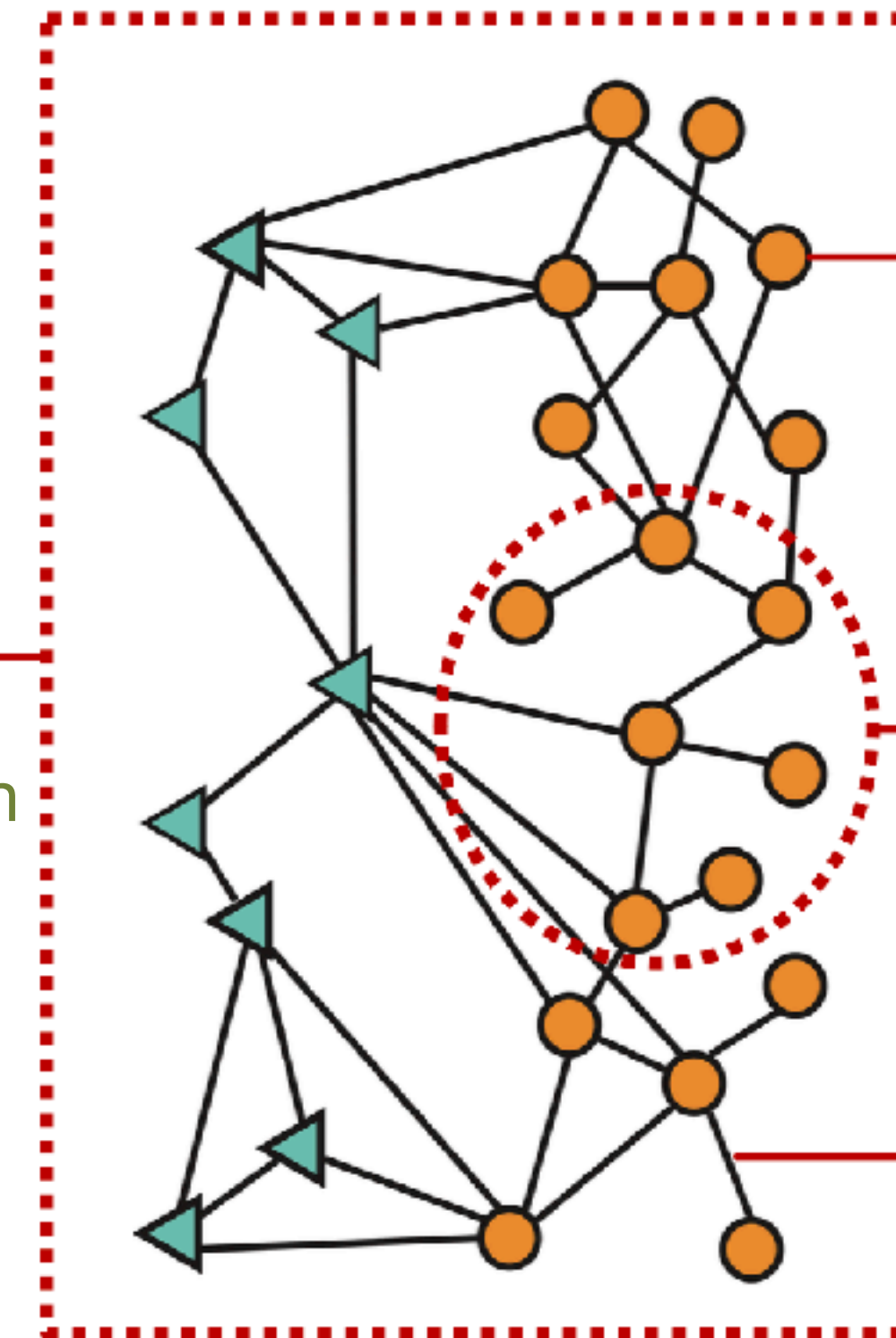


Research Background — Graphs



Graph-level

e.g., Graph Generation
/ Classification



Node-level

e.g., Node Classification

Subgraph-level

e.g., Community Detection

Edge-level

e.g., Recommendation

Graphs are a language describing
entities with relations or interactions.

<http://cs224w.stanford.edu/>

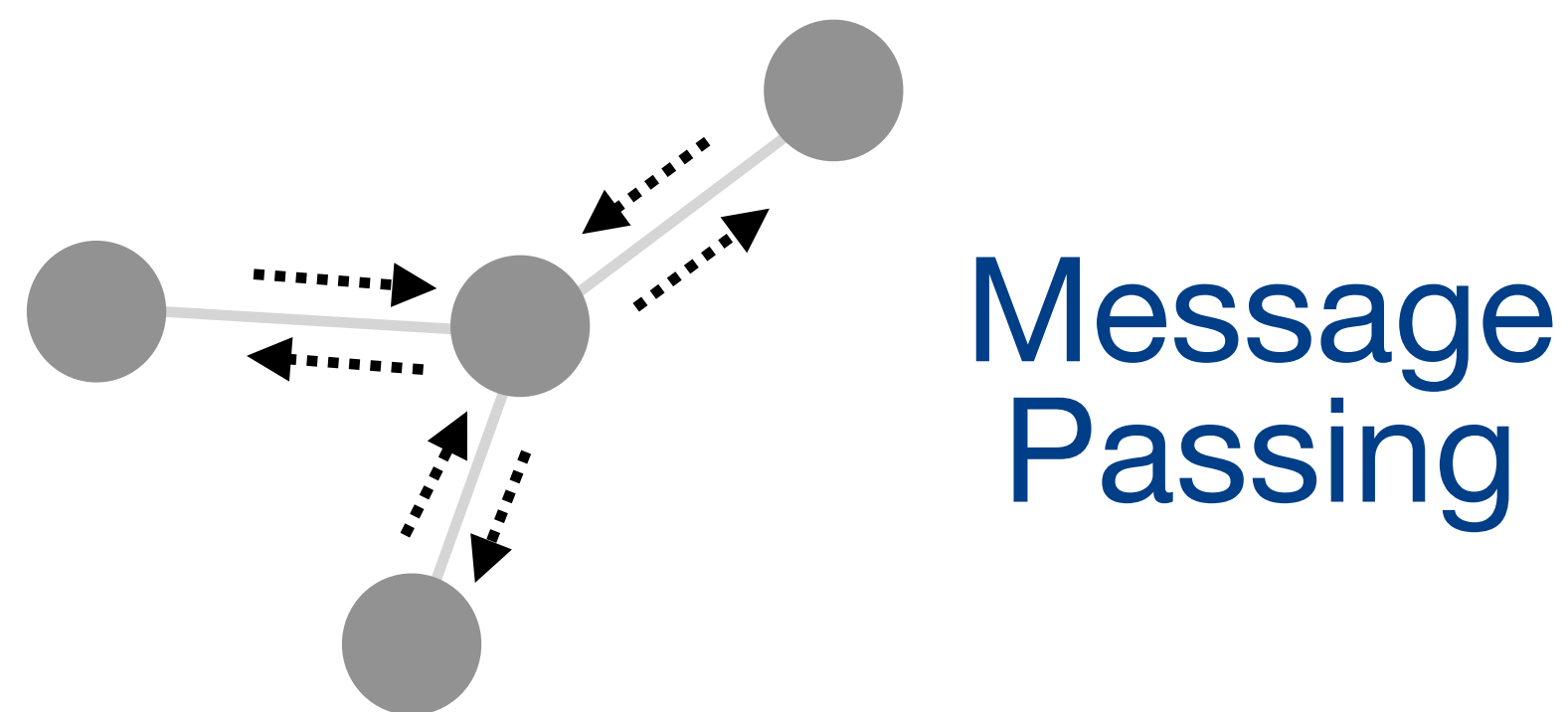
Research Background — Graph Neural Networks (GNNs)

Core Insights

- Integrate both node features and graph topology via either a **message passing framework** or a **spectral filtering operation**.

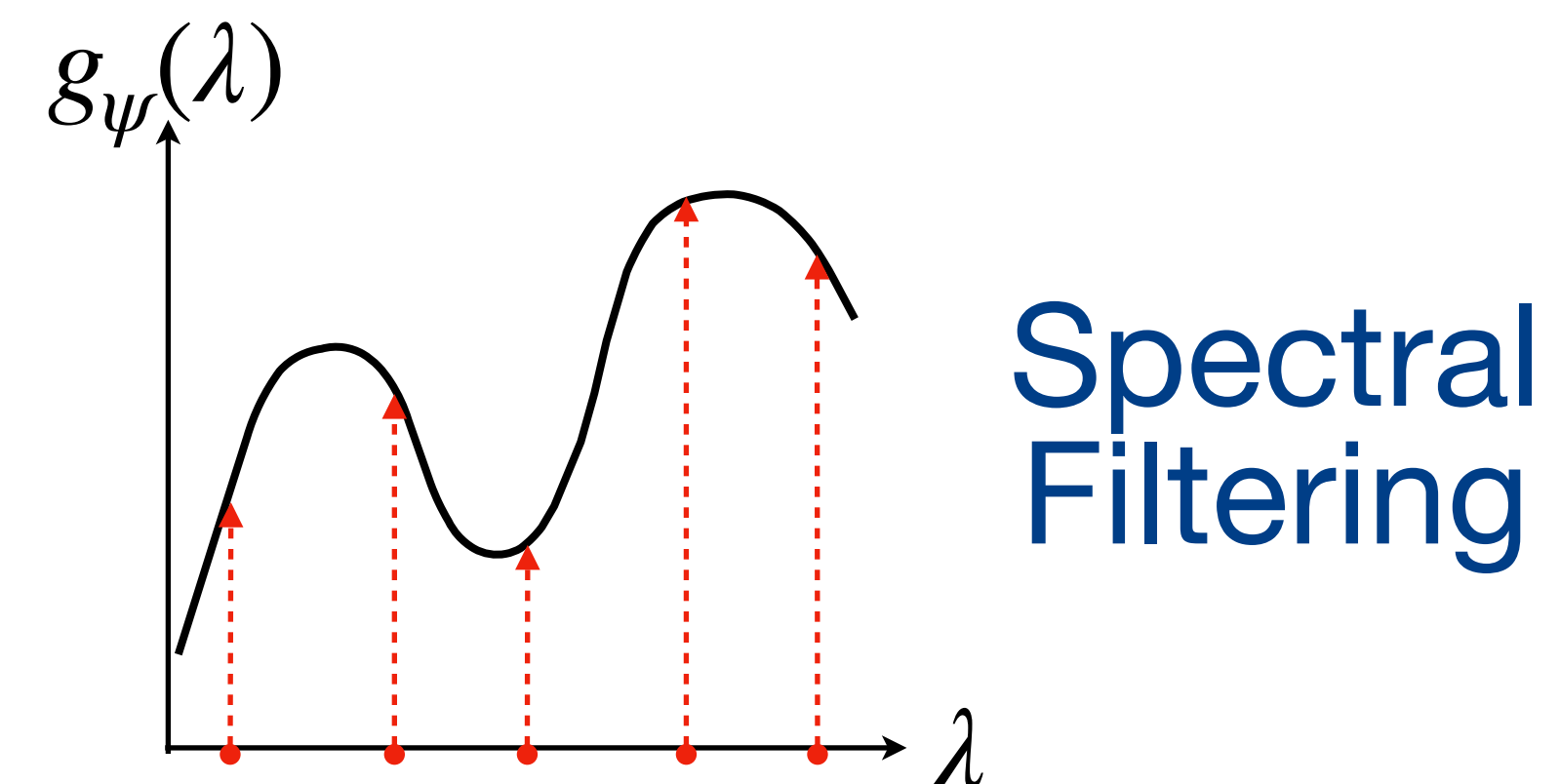
Spatial-based Methods

$$\mathbf{z}_i = f_{upd}(\mathbf{x}_i, f_{agg}(\{\mathbf{x}_j \mid \forall v_j \in N_i\}))$$



Spectral-based Methods

$$\mathbf{Z} = \mathbf{U} g_{\psi}(\Lambda) \mathbf{U}^T \mathbf{X}$$



Research Background — Graph Neural Networks

Unified Optimization Objective

- Can be interpreted as **different solutions to the same graph denoising problem**:

$$\arg \min_{\mathbf{Z}} \alpha \|\mathbf{X} - \mathbf{Z}\|_2^2 + (1 - \alpha) \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}^T \hat{\mathbf{L}} \mathbf{Z})$$



keep close to the
original features



$$\sum_{(v_i, v_j) \in E} \|\text{deg}_i^{-\frac{1}{2}} \mathbf{z}_i - \text{deg}_j^{-\frac{1}{2}} \mathbf{z}_j\|_2^2$$

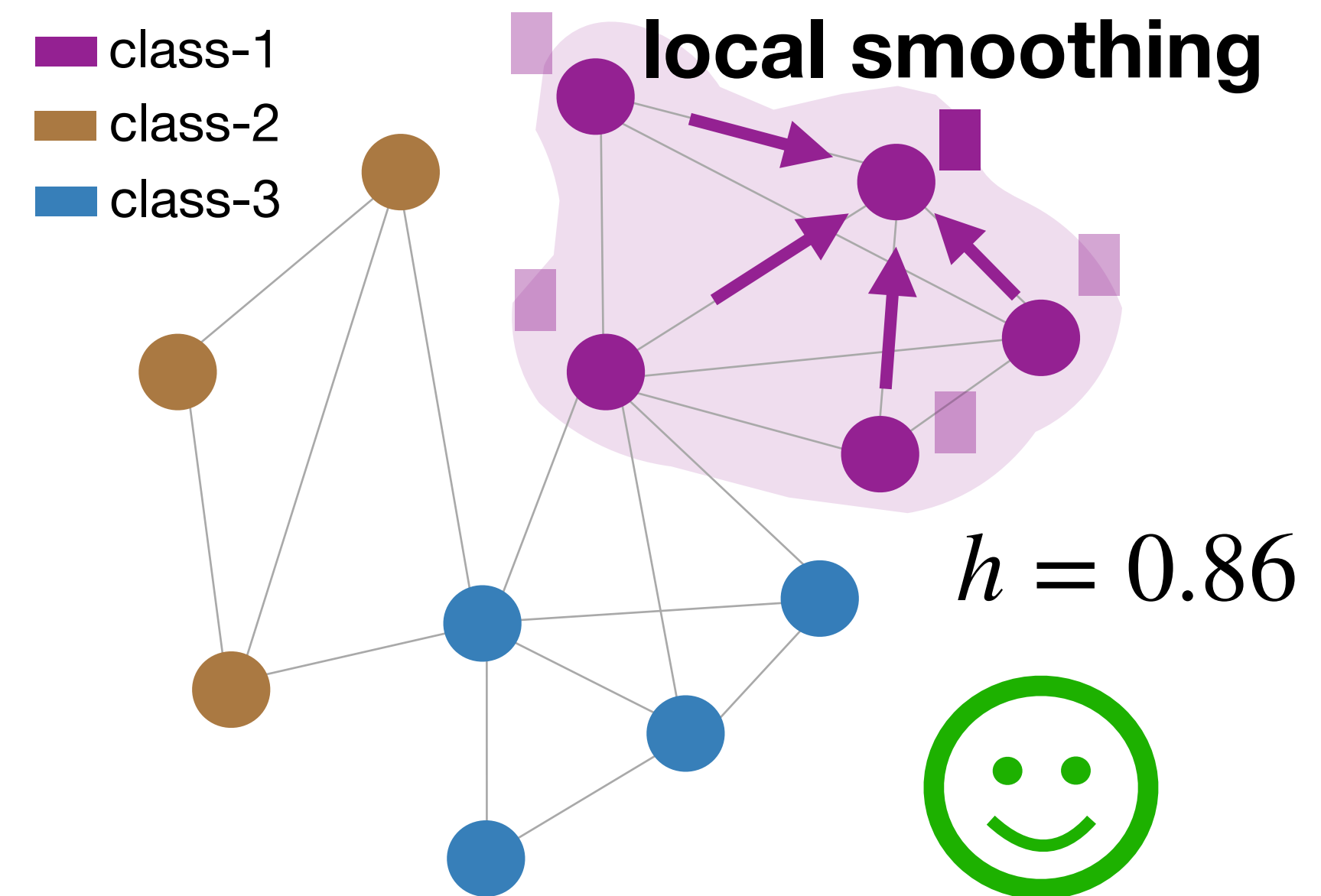
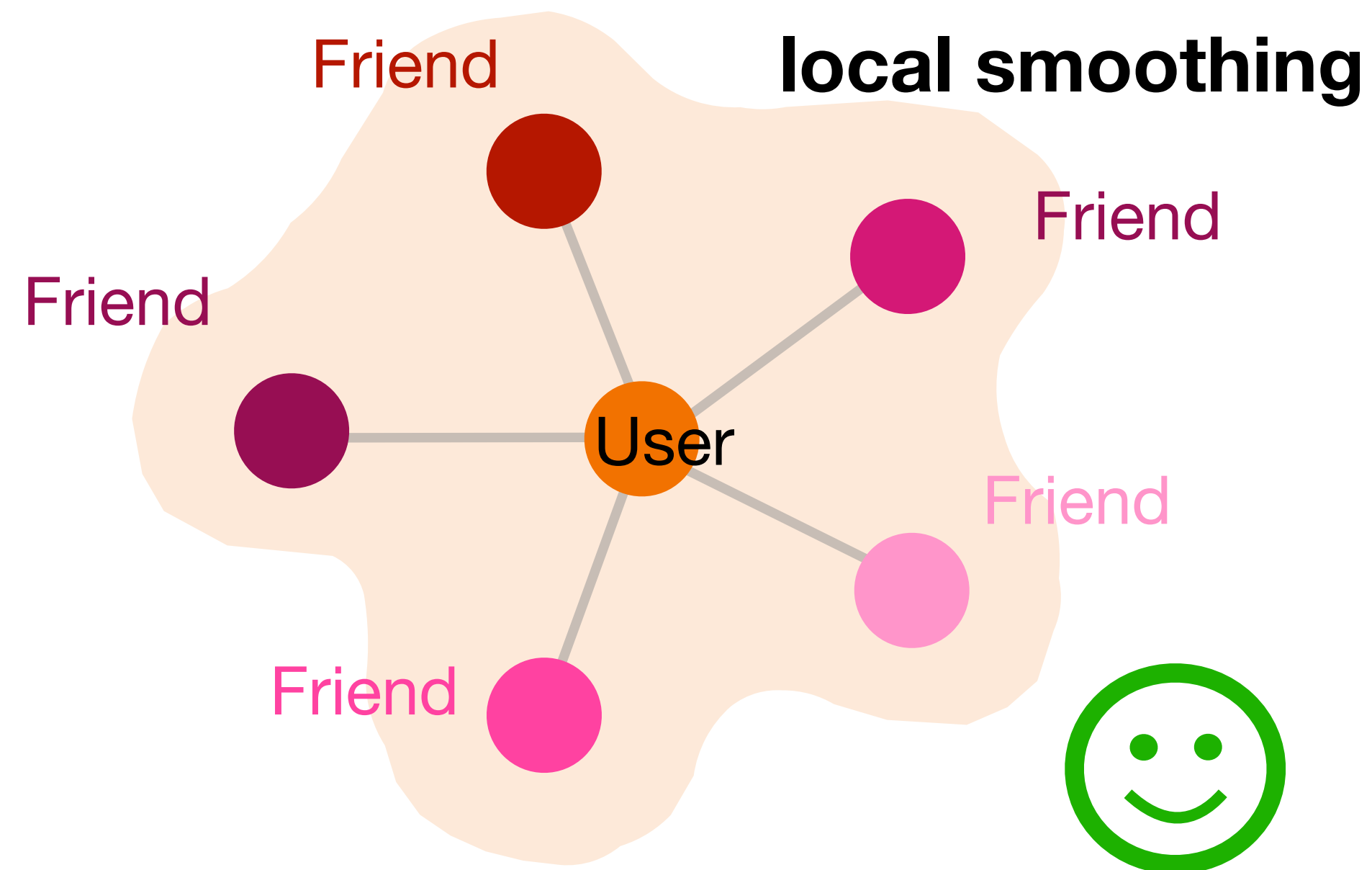
smooth node features
across the graph

Research Motivation

Idealized Scenarios

$$h = \# \text{ intra-class edges} / \# \text{ total edges}$$

- Homogenous Node Relationships
- Homophilic Linking Patterns

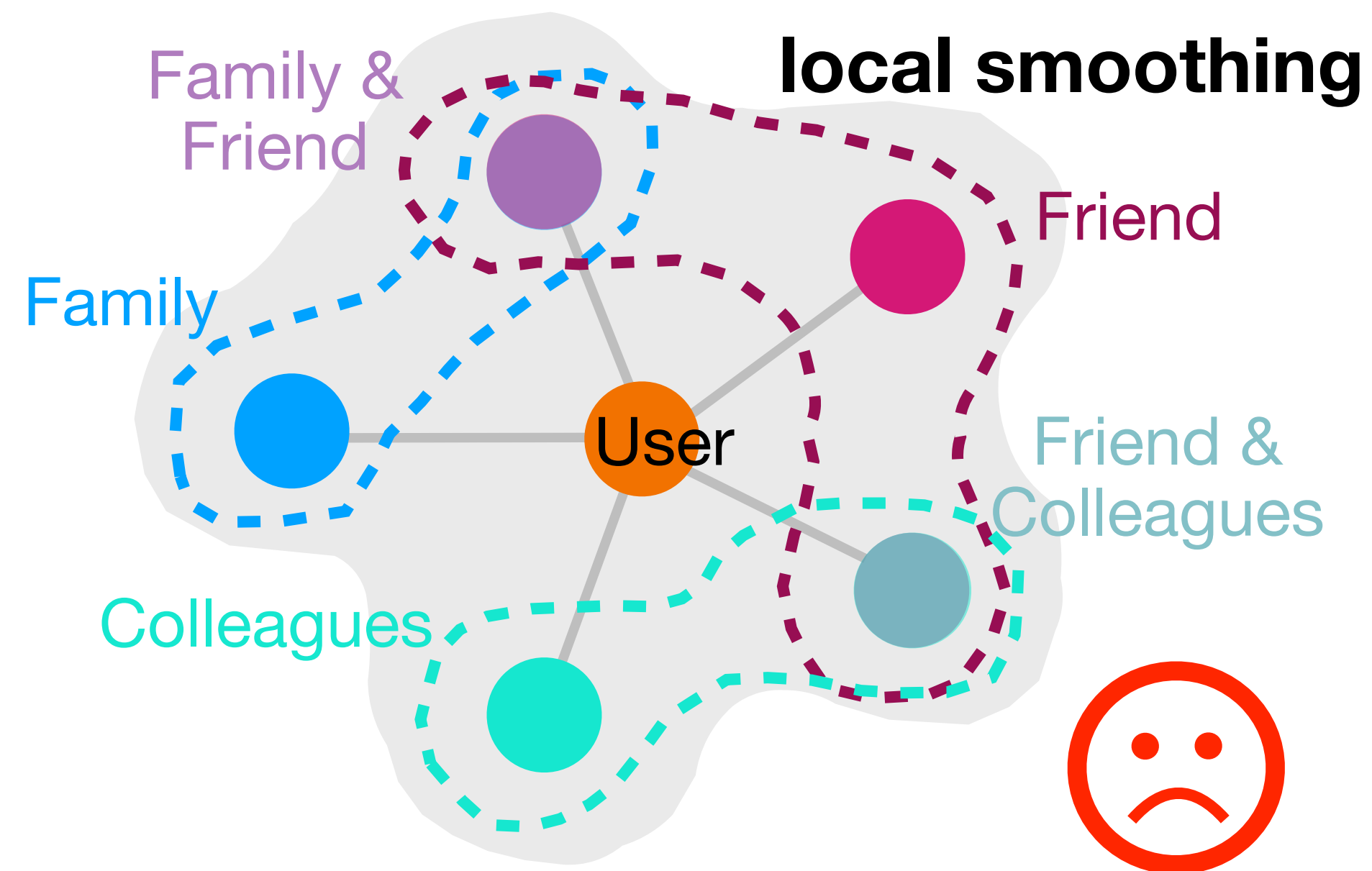


Conventional GNNs assume homogenous node interactions and employ neighborhood smoothing.

Research Challenges

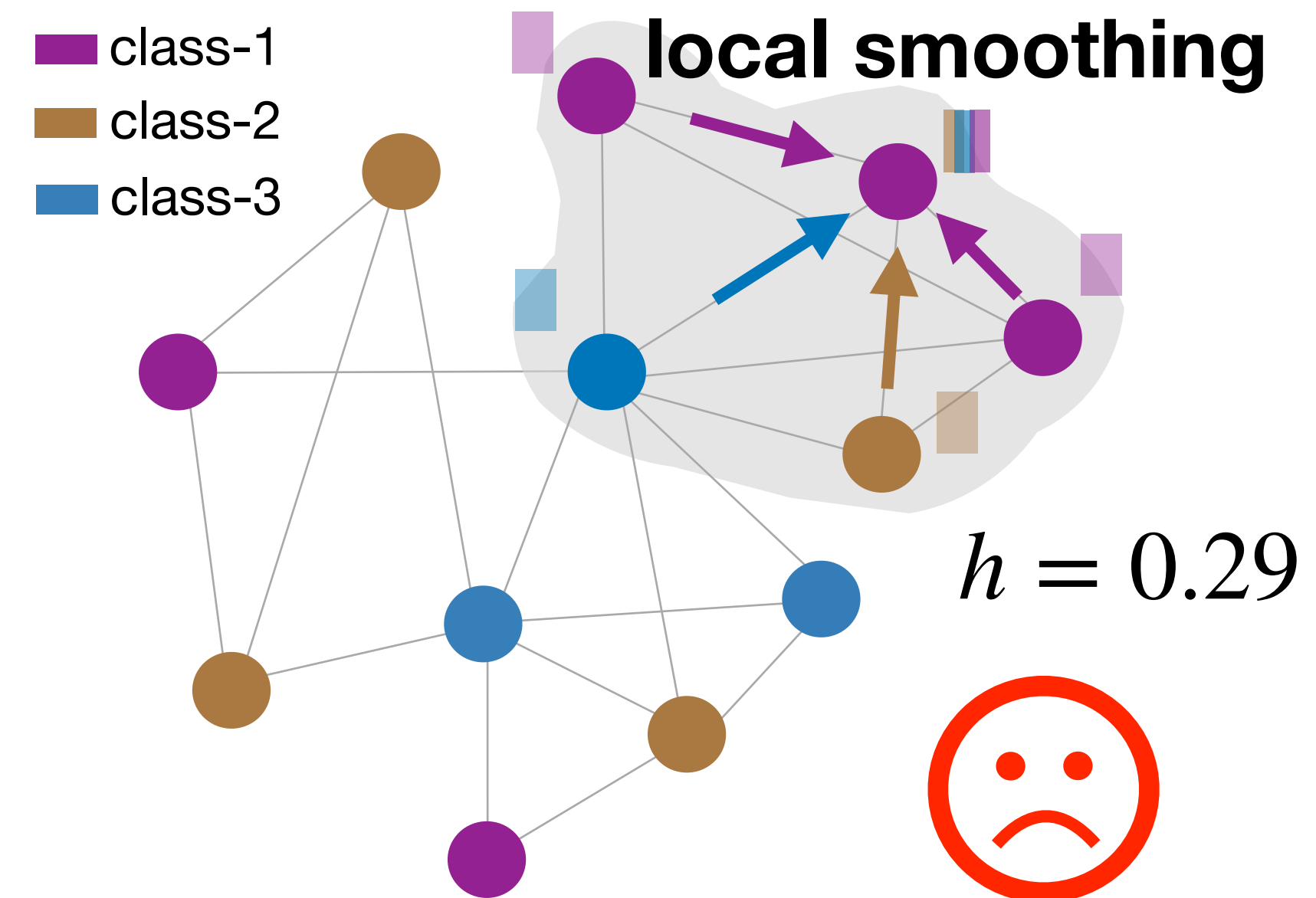
Real-world Scenarios

■ Entangled Node Relationships



■ Heterophilic Linking Patterns

$$h = \# \text{ intra-class edges} / \# \text{ total edges}$$



Conventional GNNs assume homogenous node interactions and employ neighborhood smoothing.

Proposed Solutions x 4

**How to model graphs
beyond homophily?**

Sol#1: Disentangled Node Representation Learning

Sol#2: Graph Denoising via Edge Disentanglement

Sol#3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Sol#4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

Solution #1: Disentangled Node Representation Learning

**How to model graphs
beyond homophily?**

Sol#1: Disentangled Node Representation Learning

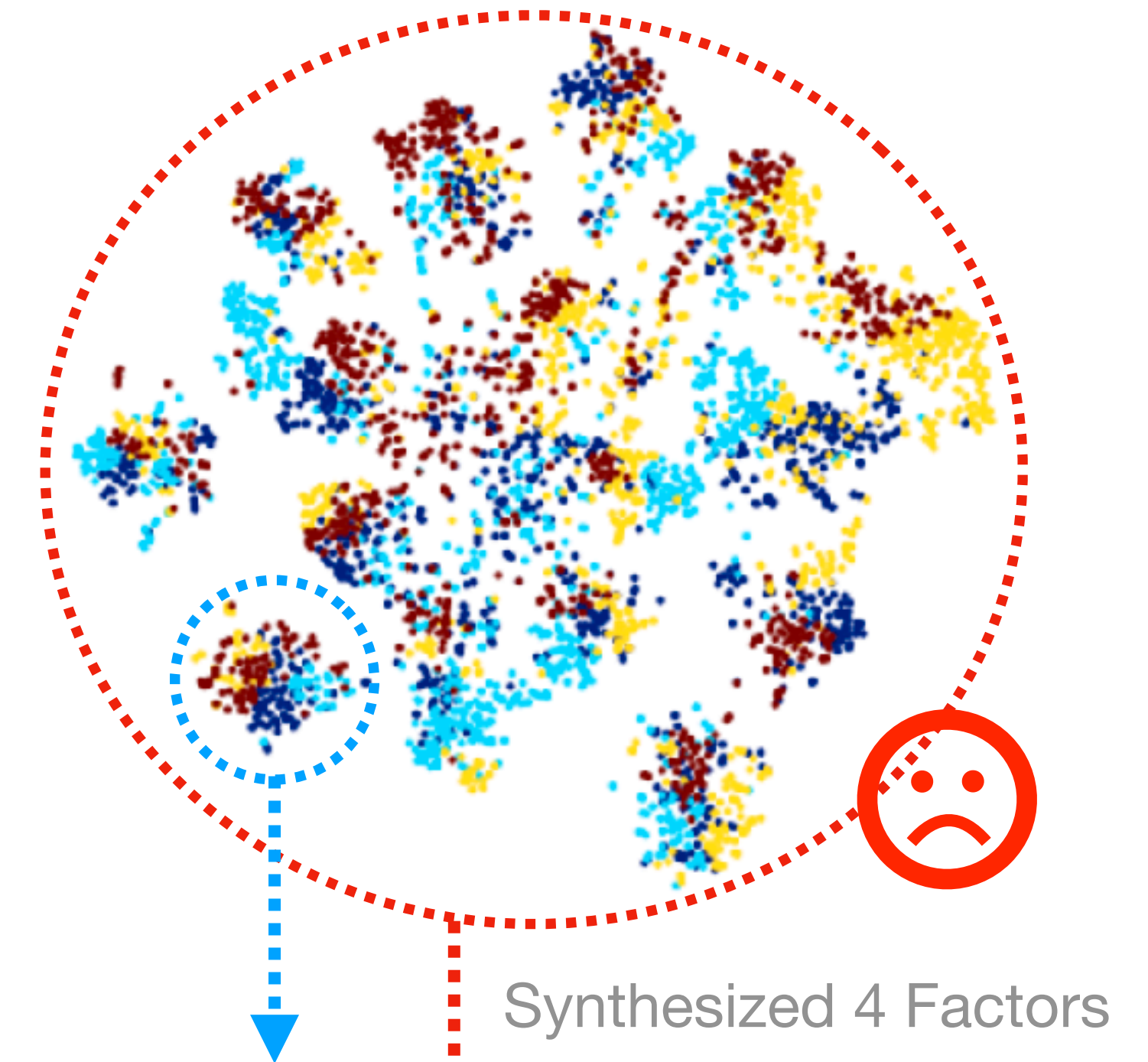
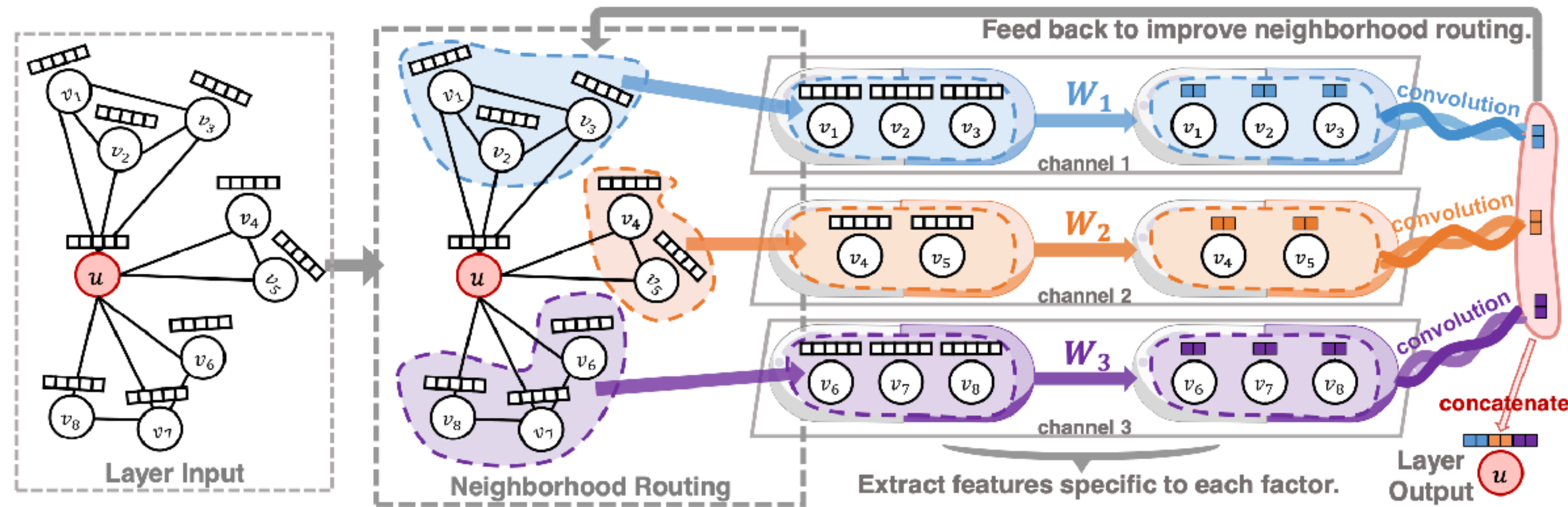
Sol#2: Graph Denoising via Edge Disentanglement

Sol#3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Sol#4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

Solution #1: Disentangled Node Representation Learning

Our Findings (on previous works)

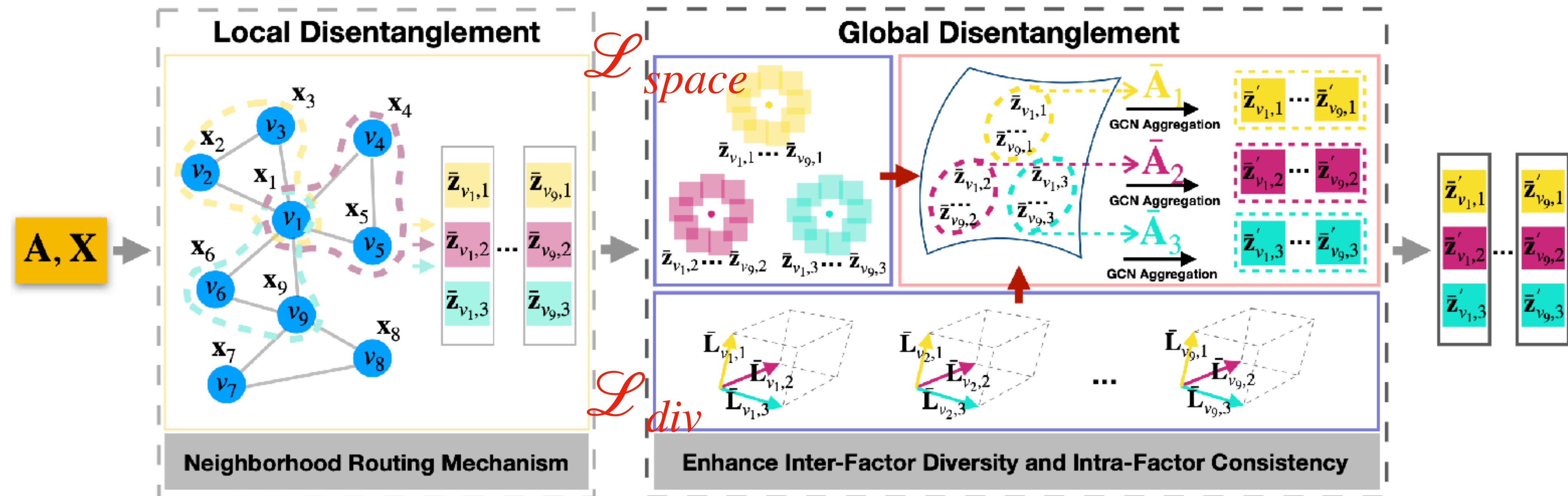


DisenGCN relies on a routing mechanism for **local neighborhood partition**.

“*disentangled locally yet entangled globally*”

Solution #1: Disentangled Node Representation Learning

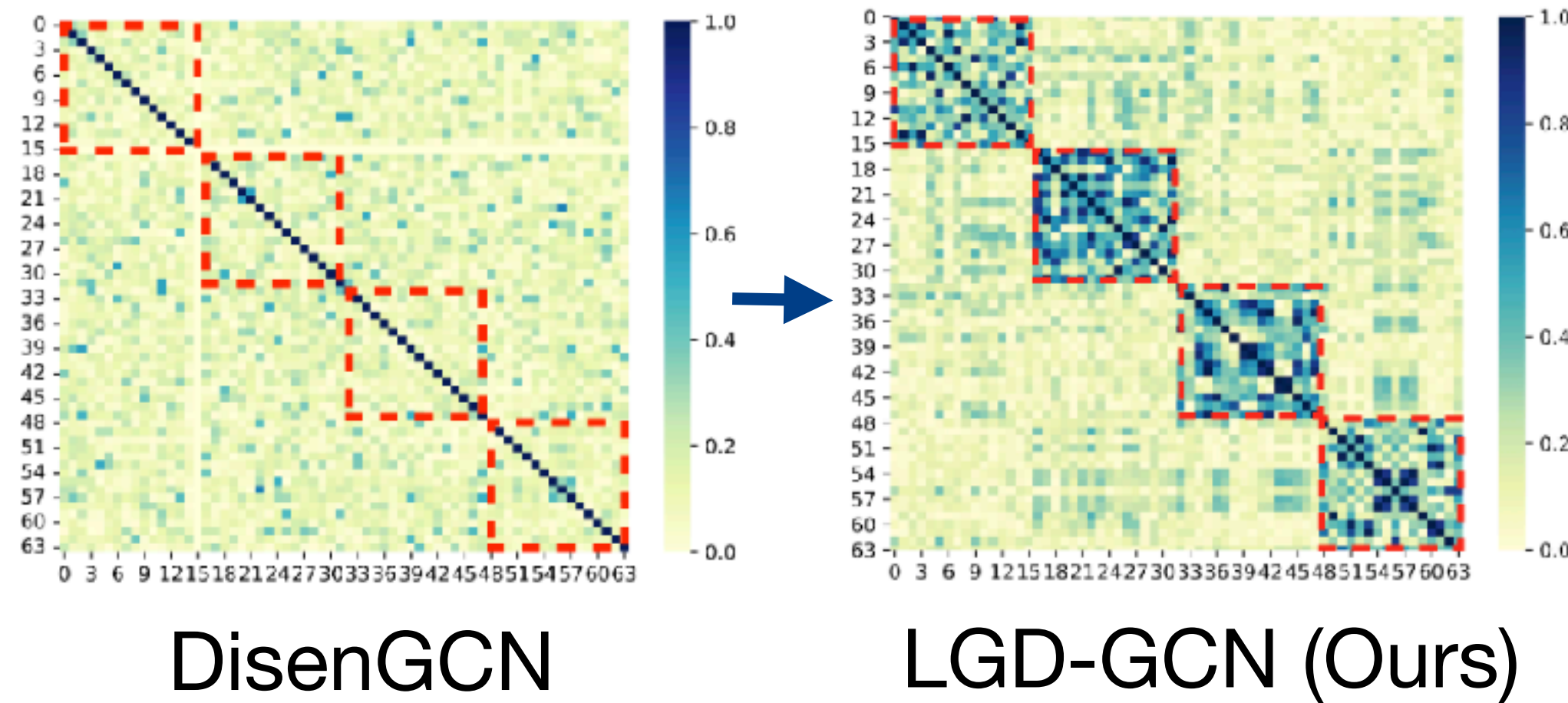
Our Modifications



Our LGD-GCN enables **global message passing** over **latent node relations** to learn disentangled representation from **complete graph views**.

Solution #1: Disentangled Node Representation Learning

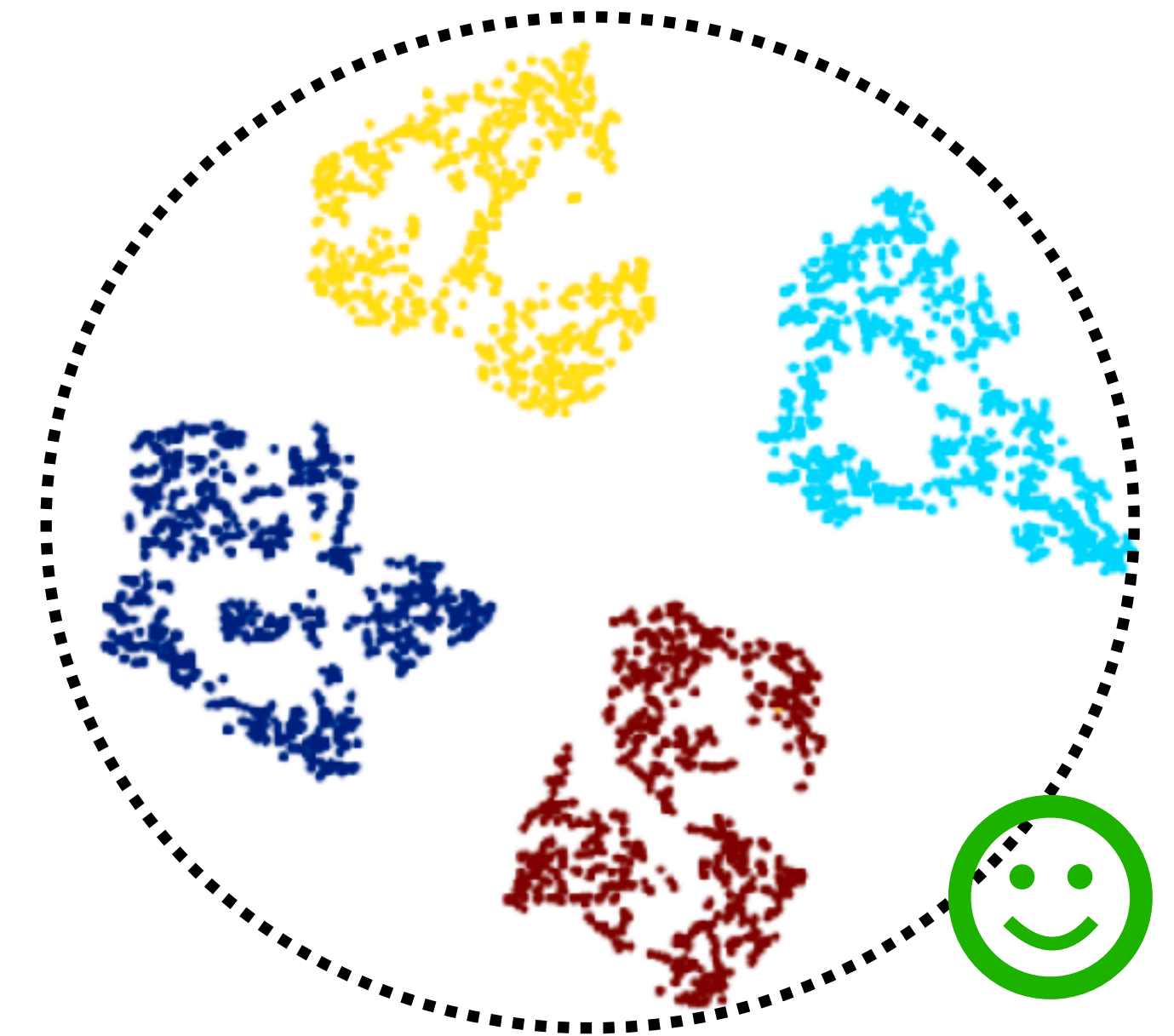
Empirical Results



Notable
Block-wise
Feature
Correlation

Accuracy
+7.4% on
Social Nets

Methods	Blogcatalog		Flickr	
MoNet [69]	74.7±0.4	74.6±0.5	61.7±0.7	61.6±1.0
GCN [6]	73.8±0.3	72.9±0.4	56.6±0.4	57.6±0.3
GraphSAGE [10]	73.7±0.3	73.0±0.4	56.3±0.4	57.0±0.4
GAT [11]	56.7±5.0	57.5±3.2	45.1±1.0	45.1±1.4
SGC [12]	74.5±0.3	73.7±0.4	61.4±0.2	60.6±0.3
JK-Net [13]	76.5±0.3	75.8±0.5	64.6±0.4	64.1±0.4
DisenGCN [17]	86.5±1.3	86.4±1.2	75.8±0.6	76.7±0.6
IPGDN [18]	86.9±0.9	86.1±1.1	75.9±0.5	76.8±0.6
FactorGCN [47]	78.4±1.3	77.6±2.1	47.0±1.7	45.4±2.0
LGD-GCN (ours)	93.7±0.4	93.9±0.4	85.5±0.6	84.0±0.8



Synthesized 4 Factors

*“disentangled both
locally and globally”*

Solution #2: Graph Denoising via Edge Disentanglement

**How to model graphs
beyond homophily?**

Sol#1: Disentangled Node Representation Learning

Sol#2: Graph Denoising via Edge Disentanglement

Sol#3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Sol#4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

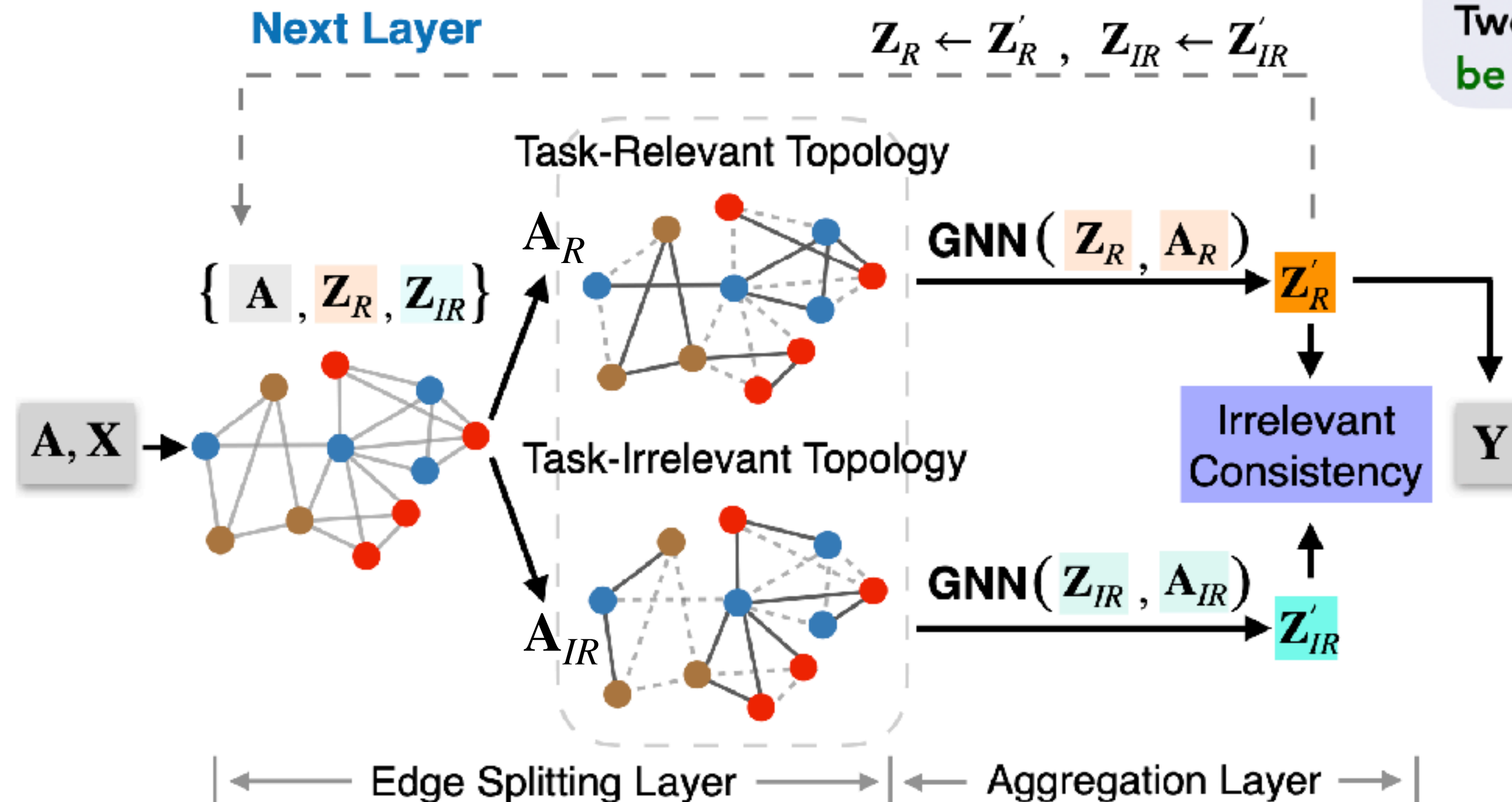
Solution #2: Graph Denoising via Edge Disentanglement

Conventional Smoothness Assumption

Two connected nodes **mostly share task-beneficial similarity**.

Disentangled Smoothness Assumption (Ours)

Two connected nodes share similarity in some features, **which could be either relevant or irrelevant (even harmful) to learning tasks**.



Our ES-GNN addresses heterophilic graphs by **partitioning network topology**, and **disentangling node features**.

Solution #2: Graph Denoising via Edge Disentanglement

Theoretical Justification

■ Conventional GNNs

Graph Denoising Problem

$$\arg \min_{\mathbf{Z}} \|\mathbf{Z} - \mathbf{X}\|_2^2 + \xi \cdot \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}^T \mathbf{L} \mathbf{Z})$$

Our Analysis $\downarrow$ $L = L_R + L_{IR}$

$$\arg \min_{\mathbf{Z}} \|\mathbf{Z} - \mathbf{X}\|_2^2 + \xi \cdot \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}^T \mathbf{L}_R \mathbf{Z}) + \xi \cdot \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}^T \mathbf{L}_{IR} \mathbf{Z})$$

Possible classification-harmful information could be preserved in $\mathbf{Z}$

■ Our ES-GNN

Disentangled Graph Denoising Problem

$$\arg \min_{\mathbf{Z}_R, \mathbf{Z}_{IR}} \|\mathbf{Z}_R - \mathbf{X}_{IR}\|_2^2 + \|\mathbf{Z}_{IR} - \mathbf{X}_{IR}\|_2^2 + \xi \cdot \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_R^T \mathbf{L}_R \mathbf{Z}_R) + \xi \cdot \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_{IR}^T \mathbf{L}_{IR} \mathbf{Z}_{IR})$$

where $\mathbf{L}_R = \mathbf{D}_R - \mathbf{A}_R$, $\mathbf{L}_{IR} = \mathbf{D}_{IR} - \mathbf{A}_{IR}$

s.t. $\mathbf{A}_R + \mathbf{A}_{IR} = \mathbf{A}$

$\mathbf{A}_{R(i,j)}, \mathbf{A}_{IR(i,j)} \in [0, 1]$.

Possible classification-harmful information can be excluded from $\mathbf{Z}_R$ & disentangled in $\mathbf{Z}_{IR}$

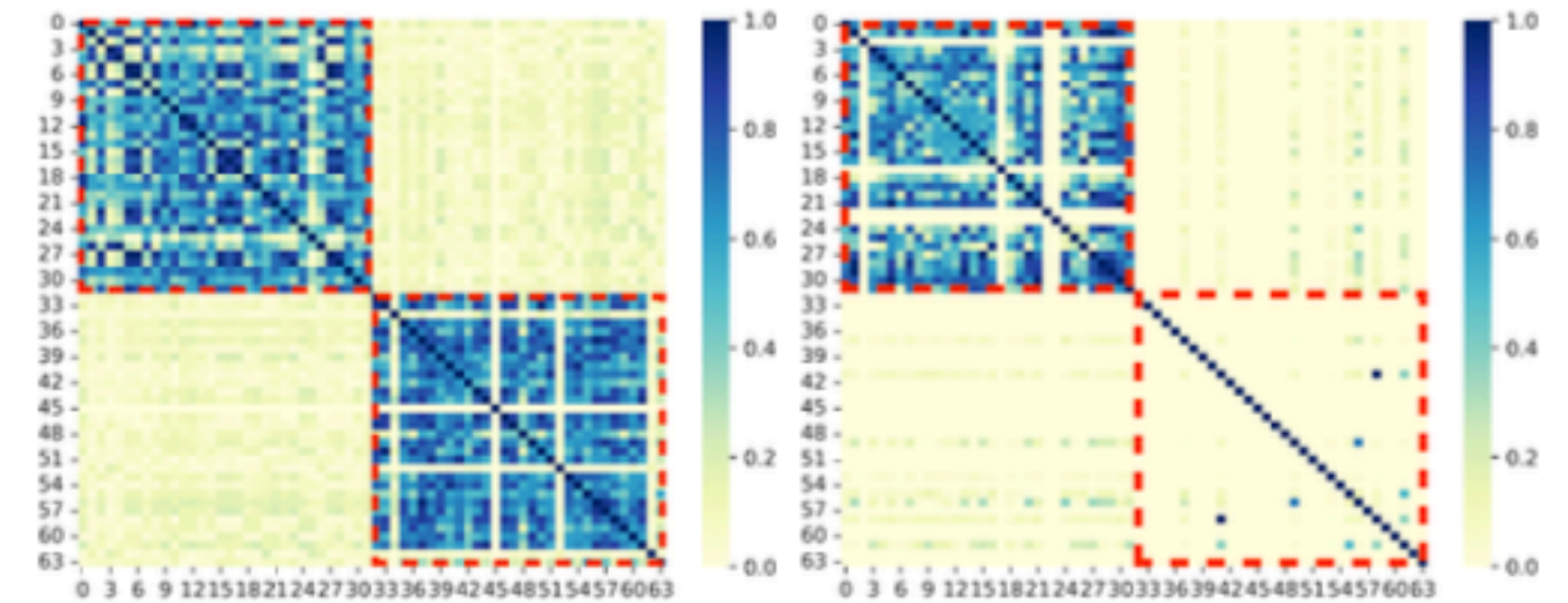
Solution #2: Graph Denoising via Edge Disentanglement

Empirical Results

Node classification accuracies (%) over 100 runs. Error Reduction gives the average improvement of ES-GNN upon baselines w/o Basic GNNs.

Datasets	Heterophilic Graphs							Homophilic Graphs			
	Squirrel	Chameleon	Wisconsin	Cornell	Texas	Twitch-DE	Actor	Cora	Citeseer	Pubmed	Polblogs
GCN [30]	55.2±1.5	67.6±2.0	59.5±3.6	52.8±6.0	61.7±3.7	74.0±1.2	31.2±1.3	79.7±1.2	69.5±1.7	78.7±1.6	89.4±0.9
SGC [6]	50.7±1.3	61.9±2.6	53.7±3.9	51.2±0.9	51.4±2.2	73.9±1.3	30.9±0.6	79.1±1.0	69.9±2.0	76.6±1.3	89.0±1.5
GAT [26]	54.8±2.2	67.3±2.2	57.9±4.5	50.4±5.9	55.4±5.9	73.7±1.3	30.5±1.2	82.0±1.1	69.9±1.7	78.6±2.0	87.4±1.1
NeuralSparse [48]	40.0±1.6	60.5±2.0	70.8±3.4	64.1±5.5	66.4±5.7	71.3±1.3	35.5±1.1	78.5±1.4	69.7±1.8	79.1±1.2	89.3±0.9
GCN-LPA [49]	54.2±1.1	63.4±1.9	63.3±3.7	65.6±7.3	61.2±7.6	74.0±1.2	37.8±0.9	80.4±1.5	69.7±1.7	79.7±1.3	89.7±0.8
DisenGCN [66]	42.4±1.6	58.4±2.3	78.1±4.0	77.4±4.4	71.3±5.7	73.5±1.7	36.7±1.2	81.5±1.3	69.2±1.7	80.0±1.6	89.5±0.9
FactorGCN [33]	56.6±2.4	69.8±2.0	64.2±4.8	50.6±1.8	69.5±6.5	73.1±1.4	29.0±1.4	75.2±1.6	61.6±2.0	72.9±2.3	87.9±1.7
VEPM [71]	50.3±1.7	67.3±2.1	55.6±4.9	51.2±7.0	55.8±4.3	73.3±1.2	29.3±1.1	82.2±1.2	69.1±1.9	78.8±1.6	89.5±0.9
DisCNN [72]	55.1±4.8	68.2±1.9	54.6±5.4	52.0±5.7	60.6±3.9	69.2±0.8	30.2±1.3	78.2±1.4	66.2±2.2	77.6±1.7	89.6±0.9
GEN [13]	36.0±4.0	57.6±3.1	83.3±3.6	81.0±3.9	78.3±8.0	74.1±1.4	37.3±1.4	79.8±1.3	69.7±1.6	78.9±1.7	89.6±1.4
WRGAT [14]	39.6±1.4	57.7±1.6	82.9±4.5	79.2±3.5	80.5±6.1	70.0±1.3	38.6±1.1	71.7±1.5	64.1±1.9	73.3±2.1	88.2±1.2
H2GCN [10]	45.1±1.9	62.9±1.9	82.6±4.0	79.6±4.9	79.8±7.3	73.1±1.5	38.4±1.0	81.4±1.4	68.7±2.0	78.0±2.0	89.0±1.0
FAGCN [18]	50.4±2.6	68.9±1.8	82.3±4.4	79.4±5.5	80.3±5.5	74.1±1.4	37.9±1.0	82.6±1.3	70.3±1.6	80.0±1.7	89.3±1.1
GPR-GNN [11]	54.1±1.6	69.6±1.7	82.7±4.1	79.9±5.3	81.7±4.9	74.0±1.6	38.0±1.1	81.5±1.5	69.6±1.7	79.8±1.3	89.5±0.8
GloGNN++ [23]	63.3±1.2	71.4±2.0	84.9±4.2	82.0±3.5	81.4±5.6	72.8±1.1	38.2±1.2	80.9±1.4	70.5±1.9	76.8±2.1	89.6±0.8
ACM-GCN [46]	67.0±1.3	75.3±2.2	84.3±4.5	82.1±4.9	82.2±5.9	74.2±0.9	36.6±1.0	81.3±1.0	69.4±1.7	79.5±1.4	89.6±0.9
GOAL [47]	57.9±0.9	71.3±2.0	70.5±5.1	54.9±6.6	72.0±7.4	68.5±1.5	36.3±1.0	80.6±1.4	69.7±2.0	78.7±1.3	88.7±1.6
ES-GNN (ours)	62.4±1.4	72.3±2.1	85.3±4.6	82.2±4.0	82.3±5.7	74.7±1.1	38.9±0.8	83.0±1.1	70.7±1.7	80.7±1.4	89.7±0.9
Error Reduction	11.5%	6.4%	11.0%	11.7%	9.4%	2.2%	3.2%	3.3%	2.3%	2.6%	0.5%

Heterophilic vs. Homophilic



(a) Chameleon

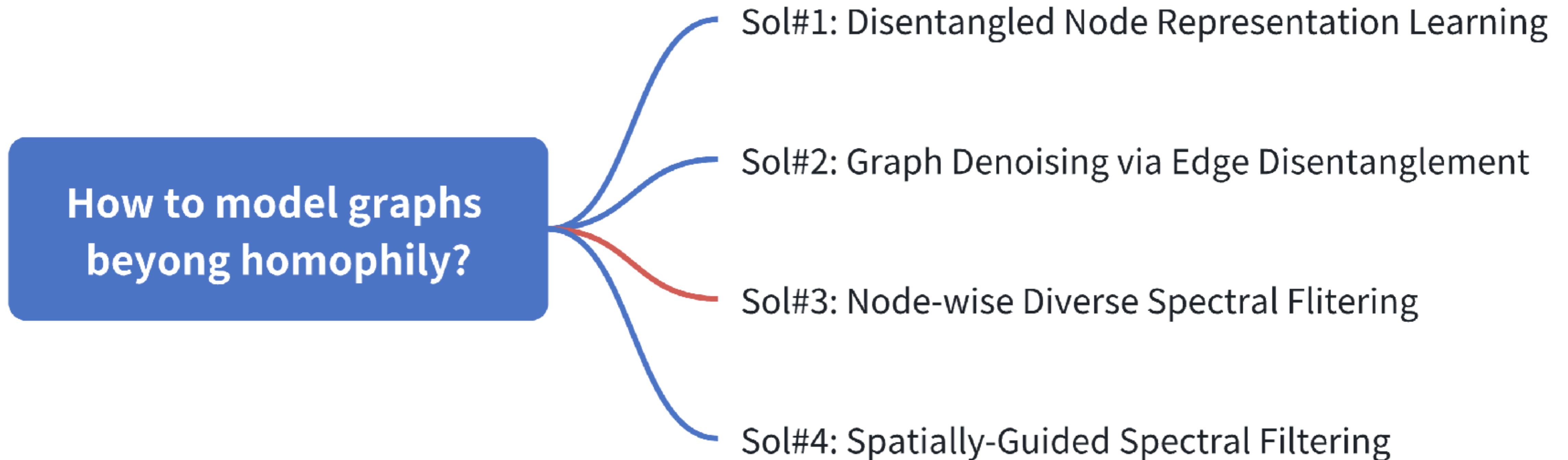
(b) Cora

Block #1: Task-Relevant

Block #2: Task-Irrelevant

ES-GNN disentangle task-relevant and irrelevant features, showcasing **universal adaptivity on different network types.**

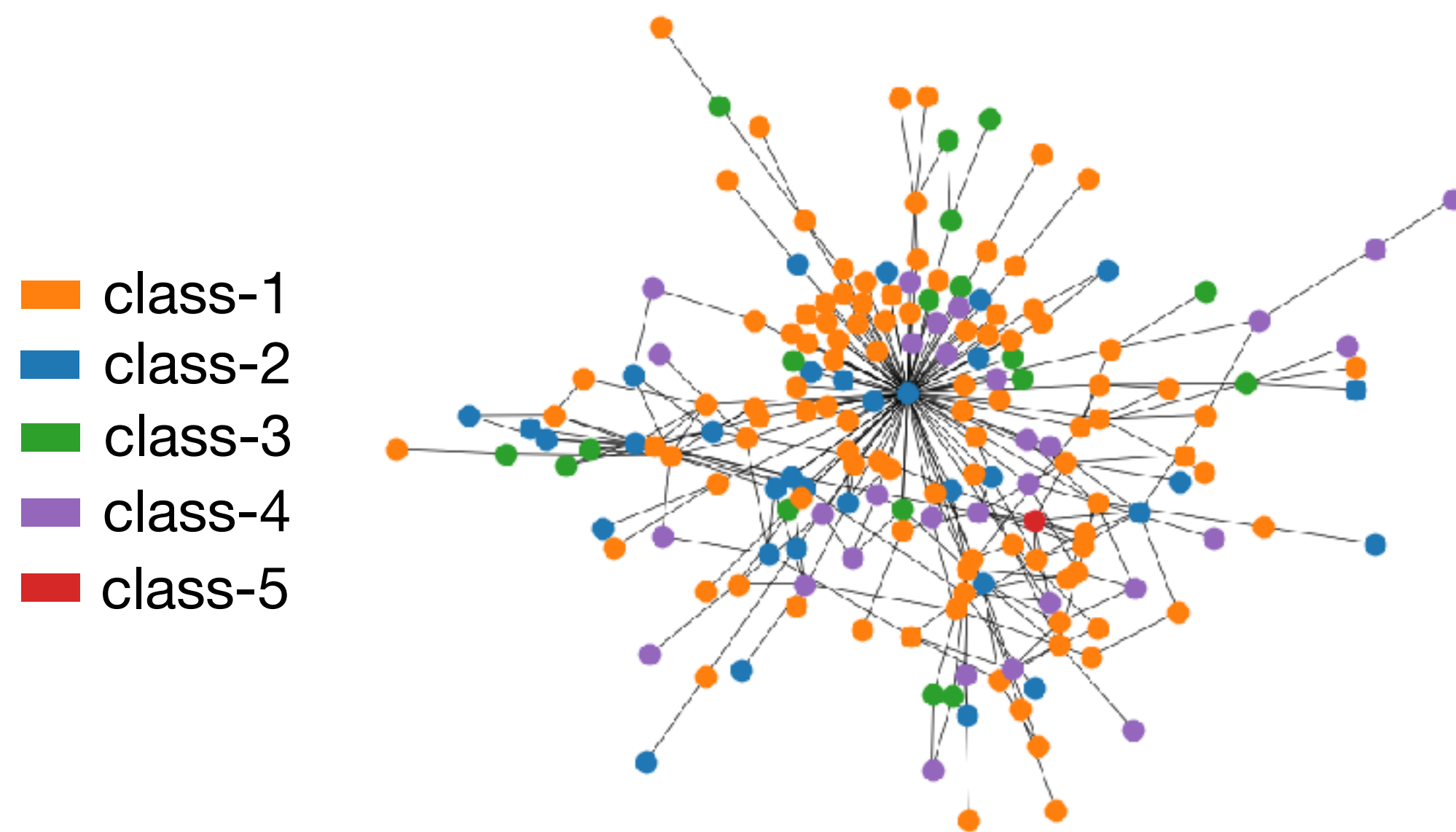
Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering



Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

New Heterophily Insights From a Broader Graph Context

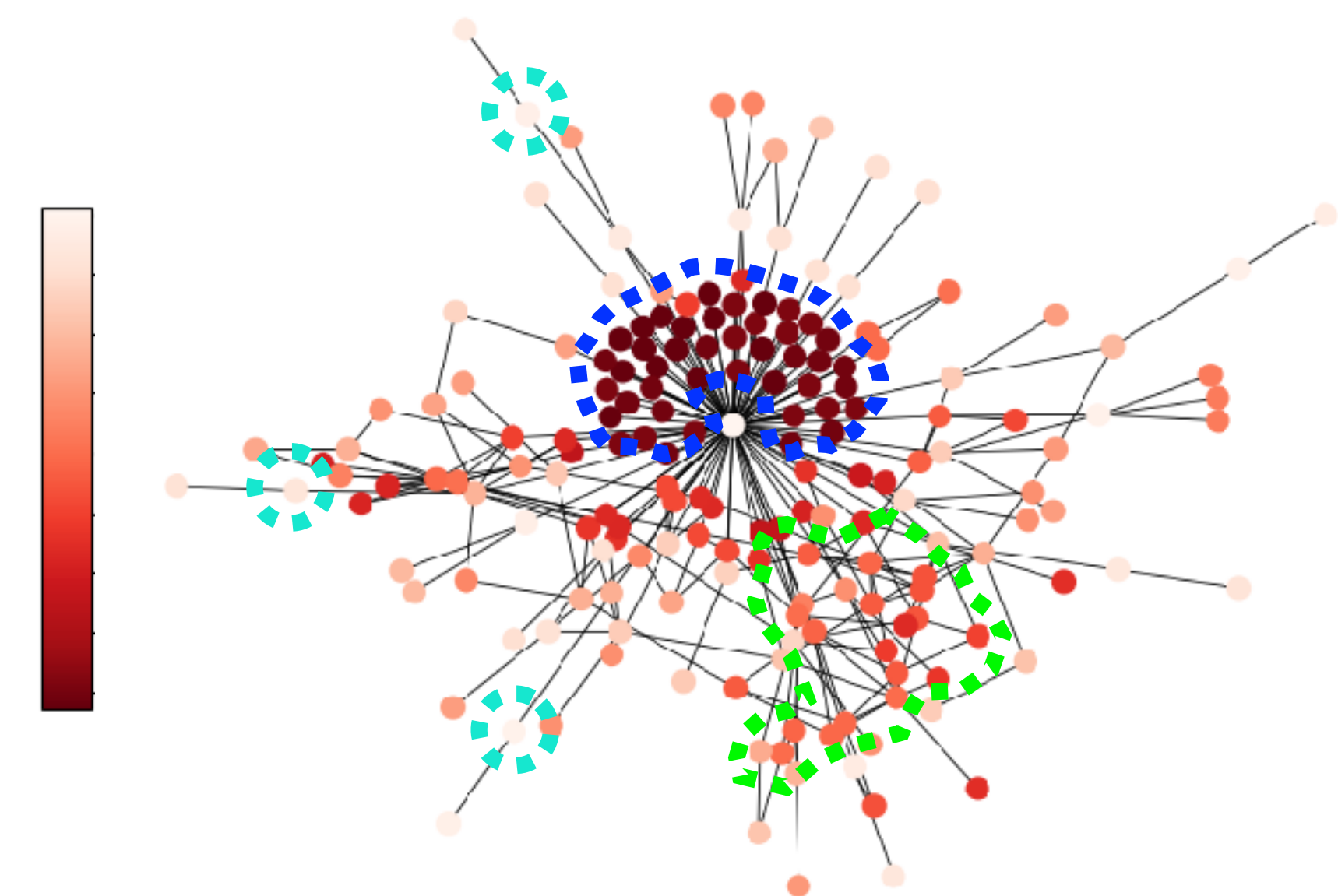
■ Edge-level



label similarity / dissimilarity

Pairwise Distinction

■ Subgraph-level



structure similarity / dissimilarity

Regional Disparity

Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

$$\mathbf{Z} = g_{\psi}(\hat{\mathbf{L}})\mathbf{X} = \sum_{k=0}^K \psi_k P_k(\hat{\mathbf{L}})\mathbf{X}$$

$\downarrow$
Filter Function

$\dashrightarrow$ Polynomial Approx. with
Shared Parameters for each
K-hop Neighborhood

Most spectral GNNs
assumes homogenous
distributions between
different graph regions. 😞

$$\mathbf{Z} = \sum_{k=0}^K \begin{pmatrix} \beta_{k,1} & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & \beta_{k,2} & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & \beta_{k,N} \end{pmatrix} P_k(\hat{\mathbf{L}})\mathbf{X}$$

We augment the original
parameters into **node-specific
filter weights** to model diverse
regional patterns. 😊

Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Definition 1 (Local Label Homophily). We define the Local Label Homophily as a measure of the local homophily level surrounding each node v_i :

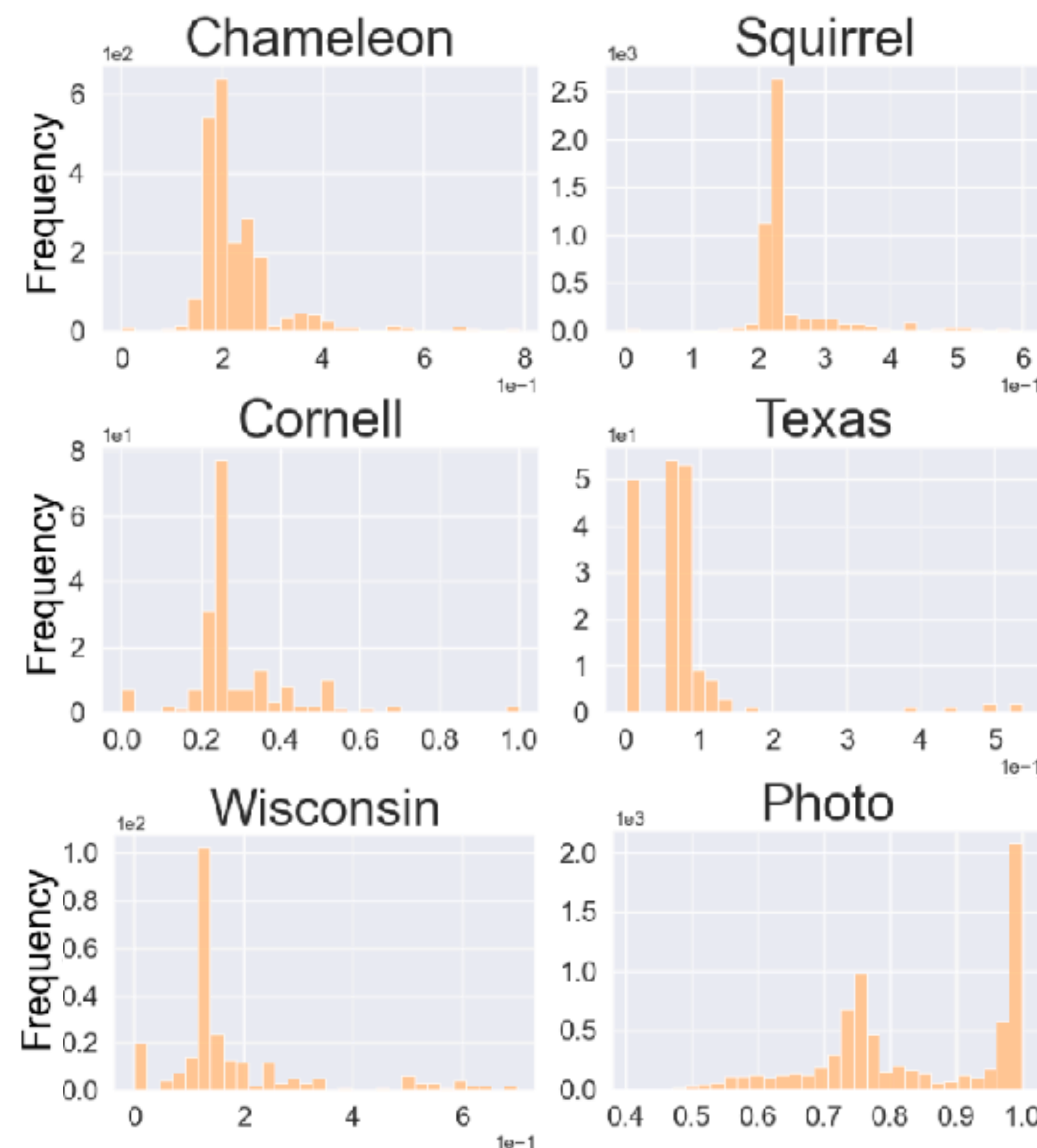
$$h_i = \frac{|\{(v_p, v_q) | y_p = y_q \wedge (v_p, v_q) \in \mathcal{E}_{i,k}\}|}{|\mathcal{E}_{i,k}|}$$

Here, h_i directly computes the edge homophily ratio [50] on the sub-graph made up of the k -hop neighbors, and $\mathcal{E}_{i,k} = \{(v_p, v_q) | v_p, v_q \in \mathcal{N}_{i,k} \wedge (v_p, v_q) \in \mathcal{E}\}$ denotes its edge set.

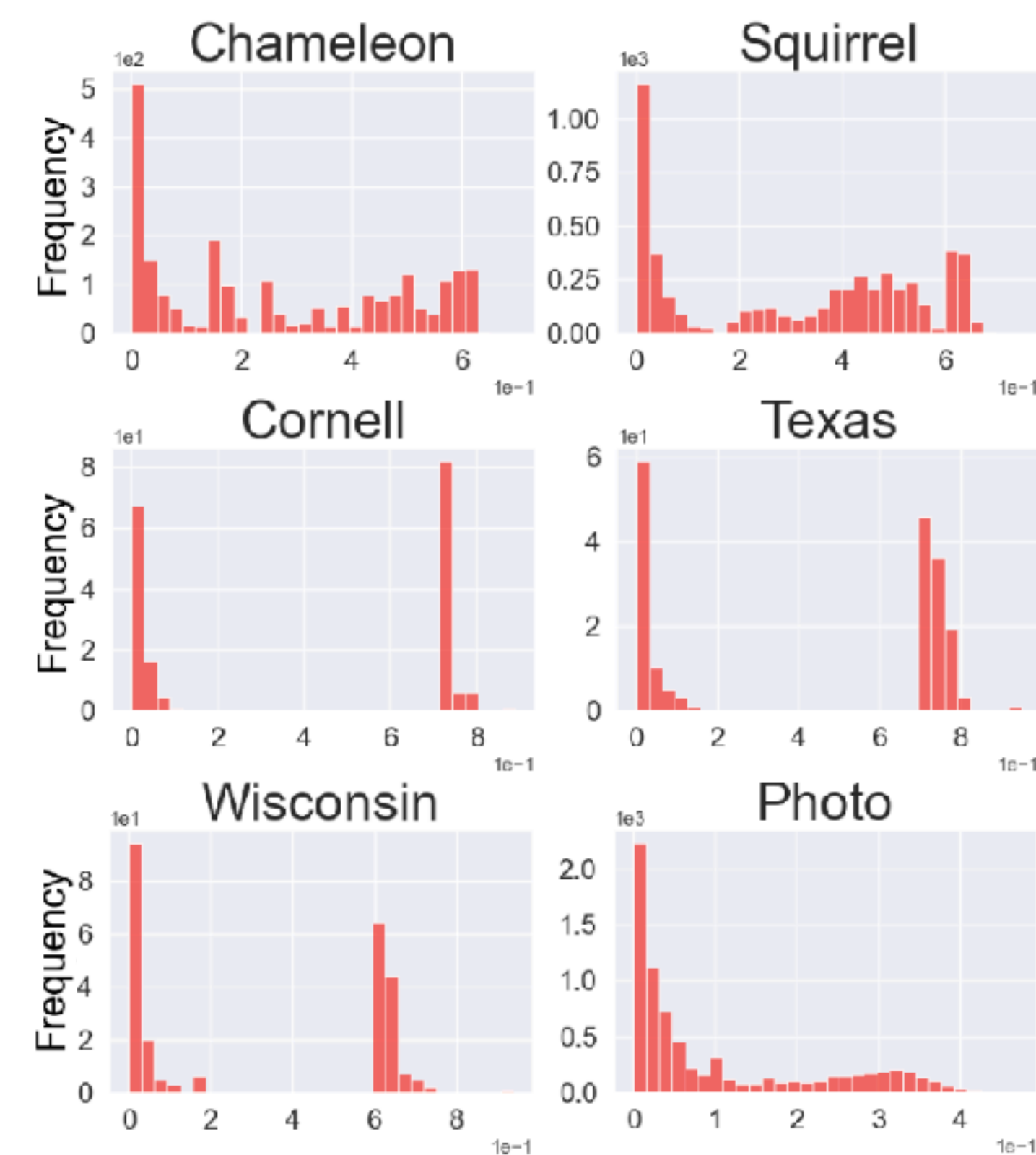
Definition 2 (Local Graph Frequency). The Local Graph Frequency is defined by measuring the local smoothness level of the decomposed Laplacian eigenbases, and for each node v_i we have:

$$\lambda_{n,i} = \sum_{(v_p, v_q) \in \mathcal{E}_{i,k}} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{\deg_p}} \mathbf{u}_{n,p} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\deg_q}} \mathbf{u}_{n,q} \right)^2$$

where $\lambda_{n,i}$ denotes the frequency or smoothness level of each Laplacian eigenbasis $\mathbf{u}_n$ upon the subgraph induced by the k -hop neighbors. Since all summed elements in Eq. 1 are positive and $\mathcal{E}_{i,k} \subseteq \mathcal{E}$, we can always have a $\xi_i \in (0, 1)$ such that $\lambda_{n,i} = \xi_i \lambda_n$.



(a) Local Label Homophily



(b) Local Graph Frequency

Regional disparity can be observed on real-world graphs via local metrics.

Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Reshaping Homogenous Spectral Filtering

$$\mathbf{Z} = \sum_{n=1}^N \tilde{\mathbf{S}}_n \cdot \mathbf{U}_n$$

Scalar coefficient Global graph frequency

↓ ↓

$$\tilde{\mathbf{S}}_n = \sum_{k=0}^K \alpha_k P_k(\lambda_n) \mathbf{U}_n^T \mathbf{X}$$



Hadamard product

↓

$$\mathbf{Z} = \sum_{n=1}^N \tilde{\mathbf{S}}_n \odot \mathbf{U}_n$$

↑

Vector

The i -th element of vector coefficients

↓

$$\tilde{\mathbf{S}}_n(i) = \sum_{k=0}^K \alpha_k P_k(\lambda_{n,i}) \mathbf{U}_n^T \mathbf{X}$$

↑

Local graph frequency

Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Key Designs

■ Approximation Trick

Proposition 1. Suppose a K -order polynomial function $f : [0, 2] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with polynomial basis $P_k(\cdot)$ and coefficients $\{\alpha_k\}_{k=0}^K$ in real number. For any pair of variables $x, \hat{x} \in [0, 2]$ satisfying $x = \xi \hat{x}$ where ξ is a constant real number, we always have a function $g : [0, 2] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with the same polynomial basis but a different set of coefficients $\{\beta_k\}_{k=0}^K$ such that $f(x) = g(\hat{x})$.

$$\sum_{k=0}^K \mathbf{U}_n \alpha_k P_k(\lambda_{n,i}) \mathbf{U}_n^T \mathbf{X} = \sum_{k=0}^K \mathbf{U}_n \beta_{k,i} P_k(\lambda_i) \mathbf{U}_n^T \mathbf{X}$$

$$\mathbf{Z} = \sum_{k=0}^K \mathbf{diag}(\beta_{k,1}, \beta_{k,2}, \dots, \beta_{k,N}) P_k(\hat{\mathbf{L}}) \mathbf{X}$$

■ Local & Global Decomposition

 global invariant graph properties

$$\beta_{k,i} \leftarrow \gamma_i \cdot \alpha_{k,i}$$

 local diverse node contexts

■ Position-aware Filter Weights

$$\arg \min_{\mathbf{P}} \|\mathbf{P}^{(0)} - \mathbf{P}\|_2^2 + \kappa_1 \text{tr}(\mathbf{P}^T \hat{\mathbf{L}} \mathbf{P}) + \kappa_2 \|\mathbf{P}^T \mathbf{P} - \mathbf{I}\|_2^2$$

$$\alpha_{k,i} = \sigma_p(\mathbf{W}^{(k)} \mathbf{P}_i^{(k)} + \mathbf{b}^{(k)}) \quad k = 1, 2, \dots, K$$

Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Empirical Results

Table 2: Node classification accuracies (%) $\pm$ 95% confidence interval over 100 runs.

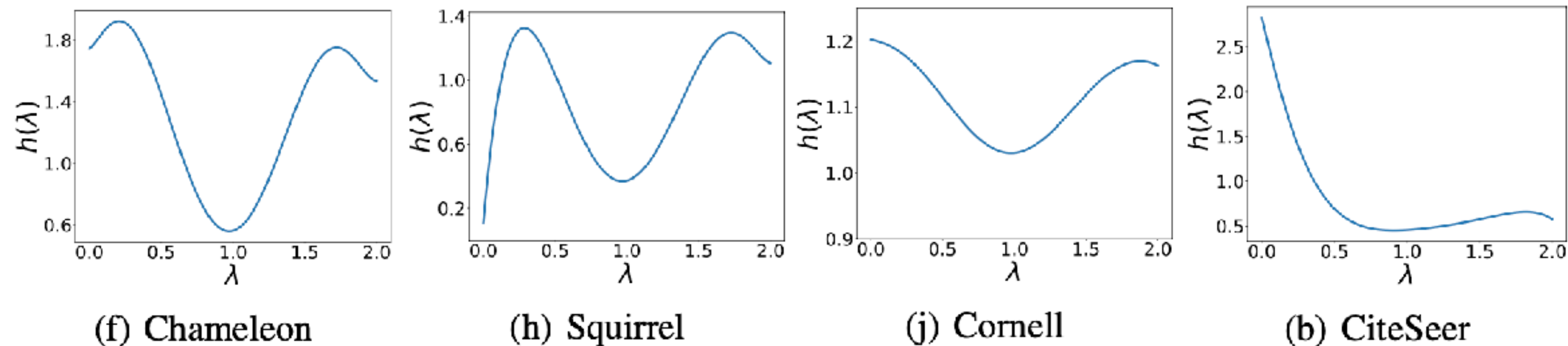
Datasets	Heterophilic Graphs						Homophilic Graphs				
	Chameleon	Squirrel	Wisconsin	Cornell	Texas	Twitch-DE	Cora	Citeseer	Pubmed	Computers	Photo
GPR-GNN [9]	69.01 $\pm$ 0.50	55.39 $\pm$ 0.33	82.72 $\pm$ 0.85	80.81 $\pm$ 0.78	81.66 $\pm$ 1.02	74.07 $\pm$ 0.18	89.03 $\pm$ 0.20	77.63 $\pm$ 0.28	90.10 $\pm$ 0.44	92.34 $\pm$ 0.13	95.34 $\pm$ 0.09
DSF-GPR-I	71.18 $\pm$ 0.52	57.08 $\pm$ 0.29	87.64 $\pm$ 0.79	84.76 $\pm$ 0.90	85.44 $\pm$ 1.05	74.58 $\pm$ 0.16	89.64 $\pm$ 0.20	78.03 $\pm$ 0.26	90.26 $\pm$ 0.08	92.49 $\pm$ 0.12	95.64 $\pm$ 0.07
DSF-GPR-R	71.64 $\pm$ 0.55	58.44 $\pm$ 0.30	87.43 $\pm$ 0.74	84.93 $\pm$ 0.90	85.56 $\pm$ 0.93	74.81 $\pm$ 0.14	89.63 $\pm$ 0.17	78.22 $\pm$ 0.29	90.51 $\pm$ 0.07	92.80 $\pm$ 0.12	95.73 $\pm$ 0.08
Our Improv.	2.63%	3.05%	4.92%	4.12%	3.9%	0.74%	0.61%	0.59%	0.41%	0.46%	0.39%
BernNet [20]	70.59 $\pm$ 0.42	56.63 $\pm$ 0.32	85.00 $\pm$ 0.94	82.10 $\pm$ 0.95	82.20 $\pm$ 0.98	74.45 $\pm$ 0.15	88.72 $\pm$ 0.23	77.52 $\pm$ 0.29	90.21 $\pm$ 0.46	92.57 $\pm$ 0.10	95.42 $\pm$ 0.08
DSF-Bern-I	72.95 $\pm$ 0.53	59.45 $\pm$ 0.32	88.23 $\pm$ 0.81	85.07 $\pm$ 0.93	84.59 $\pm$ 1.07	74.96 $\pm$ 0.15	89.05 $\pm$ 0.22	78.32 $\pm$ 0.27	90.40 $\pm$ 0.10	92.76 $\pm$ 0.10	95.73 $\pm$ 0.07
DSF-Bern-R	73.60 $\pm$ 0.53	59.99 $\pm$ 0.30	88.02 $\pm$ 0.91	84.29 $\pm$ 0.93	84.42 $\pm$ 1.00	75.00 $\pm$ 0.15	89.10 $\pm$ 0.22	78.27 $\pm$ 0.26	90.52 $\pm$ 0.10	92.84 $\pm$ 0.10	95.79 $\pm$ 0.06
Our Improv.	3.01%	3.36%	3.23%	2.97%	2.39%	0.55%	0.38%	0.80%	0.31%	0.27%	0.37%
JacobiConv [42]	73.71 $\pm$ 0.42	57.22 $\pm$ 0.24	83.21 $\pm$ 0.68	82.34 $\pm$ 0.88	82.42 $\pm$ 0.90	74.34 $\pm$ 0.12	89.24 $\pm$ 0.19	77.81 $\pm$ 0.29	89.50 $\pm$ 0.47	92.26 $\pm$ 0.10	95.62 $\pm$ 0.06
DSF-Jacobi-I	74.88 $\pm$ 0.39	58.26 $\pm$ 0.26	85.34 $\pm$ 0.74	84.54 $\pm$ 0.81	83.68 $\pm$ 1.12	74.65 $\pm$ 0.13	89.54 $\pm$ 0.19	78.18 $\pm$ 0.26	89.78 $\pm$ 0.09	92.38 $\pm$ 0.11	95.76 $\pm$ 0.07
DSF-Jacobi-R	75.00 $\pm$ 0.38	59.23 $\pm$ 0.27	86.13 $\pm$ 0.70	84.39 $\pm$ 0.88	84.46 $\pm$ 0.81	74.75 $\pm$ 0.15	89.66 $\pm$ 0.19	78.23 $\pm$ 0.25	90.07 $\pm$ 0.10	92.44 $\pm$ 0.11	95.75 $\pm$ 0.08
Our Improv.	1.29%	2.01%	2.92%	2.20%	2.04%	0.41%	0.42%	0.42%	0.41%	0.18%	0.14%

DSF can be readily **plug-and-play** in multiple spectral GNNs and **consistently improve** their performance.

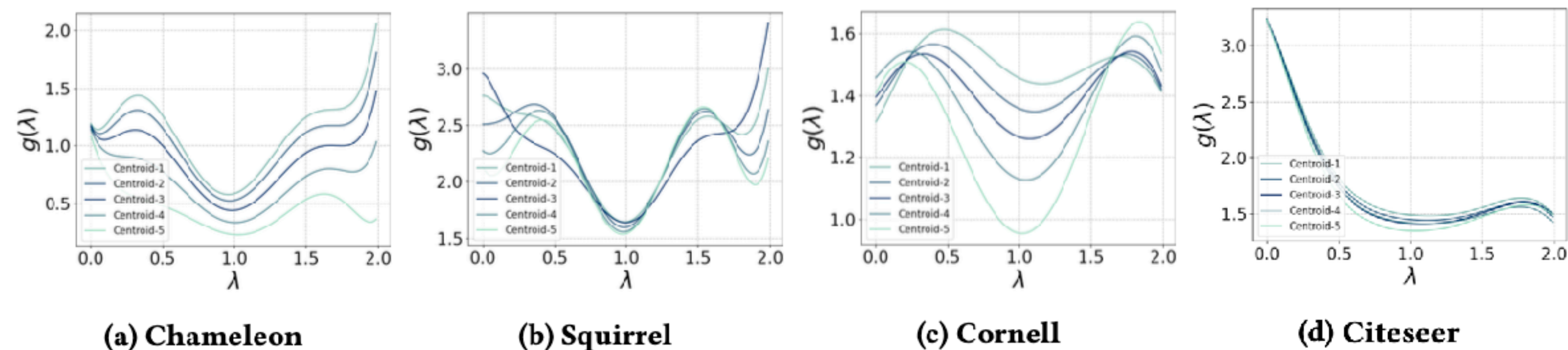
Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Empirical Results — Interpretable Analysis #1

■ Traditional Spectral Filter (BernNet as a case):

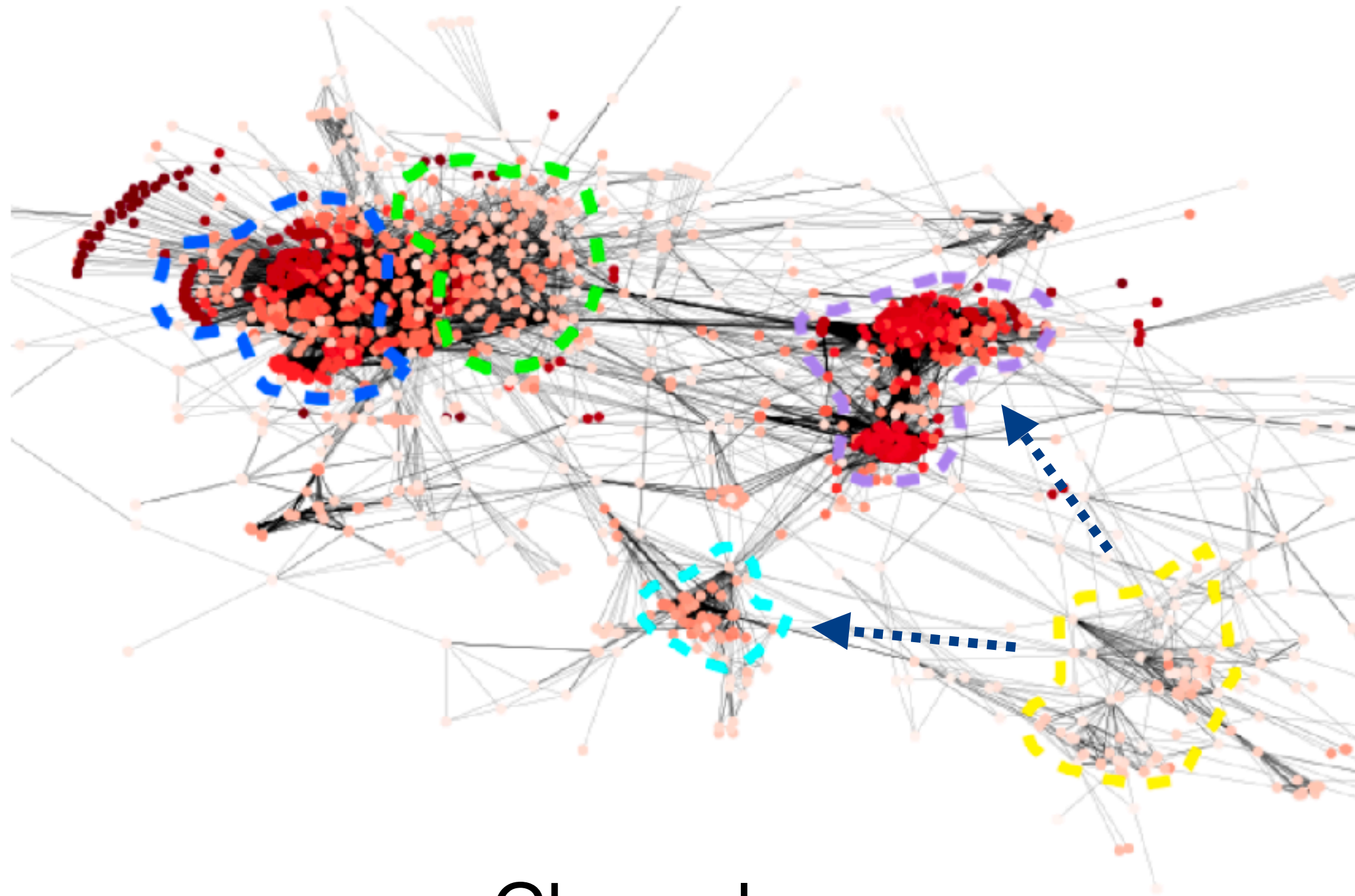


■ Our Spectral Filter (DSF-Bern):

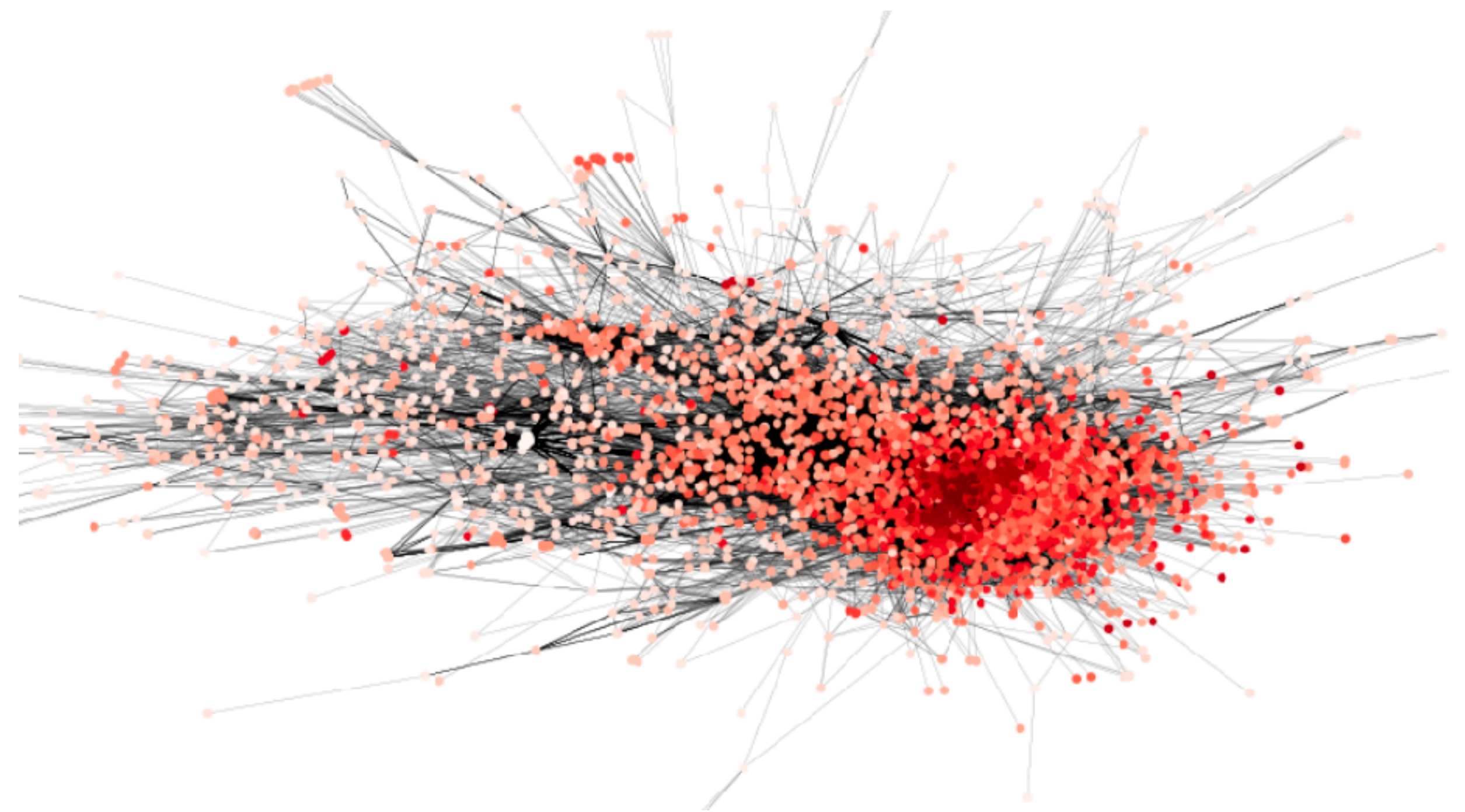


Solution #3: Node-wise Diverse Spectral Filtering

Empirical Results — Interpretable Analysis #2



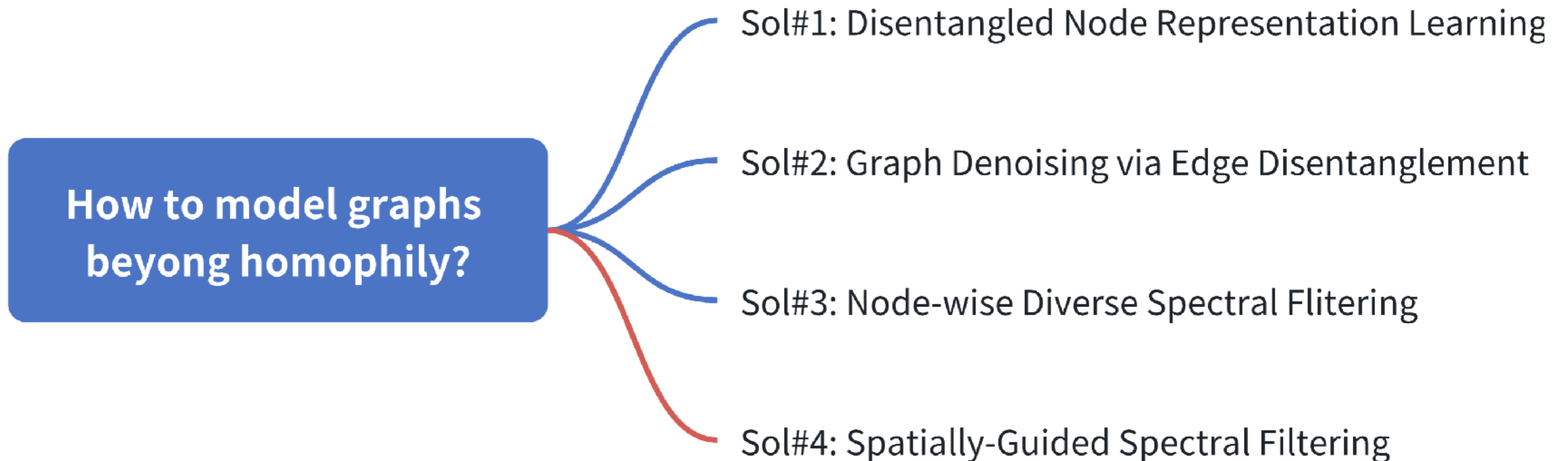
Chameleon



Squirrel

DSF captures **regional disparity** with node-specific filter weights.

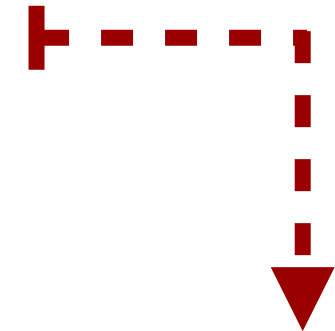
Solution #4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering



Solution #4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

Deep Delve into Spectral GNNs

■ $\mathbf{Z} = \mathbf{U}g_{\psi}(\mathbf{\Lambda})\mathbf{U}^T\mathbf{X}$  theoretical spectral filtering

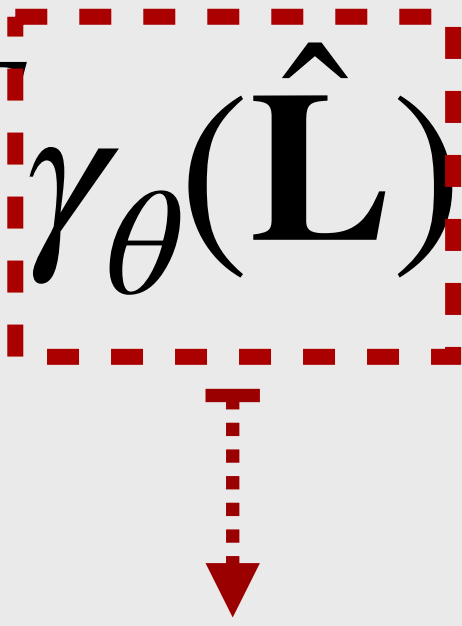
$$= g_{\psi}(\hat{\mathbf{L}})\mathbf{X} \approx \sum_{k=0}^K \psi_k P_k(\hat{\mathbf{L}})\mathbf{X} = \sum_{k=0}^K \omega_k \hat{\mathbf{A}}^k \mathbf{X}$$


practical spatial aggregation /
message passing

- What information is essentially encoded by spectral GNNs in the spatial domain?

Solution #4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

Cross-Domain Interplay via a Generalized Graph Optimization

$$\arg \min_{\mathbf{Z}} \mathcal{L} = \alpha \|\mathbf{X} - \mathbf{Z}\|_2^2 + (1 - \alpha) \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}^T \gamma_{\theta}(\hat{\mathbf{L}}) \mathbf{Z})$$


- $\mathbf{Z}$ refer to node representations

- α is a trade-off coefficient

- $\gamma_{\theta}(\hat{\mathbf{L}}) = \mathbf{U} \gamma_{\theta}(\mathbf{\Lambda}) \mathbf{U}^T$ determines propagation rate where $\gamma_{\theta}(\lambda) \geq 0$

Arbitrary Linking Patterns

Positive Semi-definite Constraint for Convexity Optimization

Solution #4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

- Closed-form Solution $\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \mathbf{Z}} = 0$

$$\mathbf{Z}^* = (\mathbf{I} + \frac{1 - \alpha}{\alpha} \gamma_{\theta}(\hat{\mathbf{L}}))^{-1} \mathbf{X} = g_{\psi}(\hat{\mathbf{L}}) \mathbf{X} = \mathbf{U} g_{\psi}(\Lambda) \mathbf{U}^T \mathbf{X}$$

Spectral Filter as a function of $\gamma_{\theta}(\cdot)$: $g_{\psi}(\lambda) = (1 + \frac{1 - \alpha}{\alpha} \gamma_{\theta}(\lambda))^{-1}$

- Iterative Solution $\mathbf{Z}^{(k)} = \mathbf{Z}^{(k-1)} - \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \mathbf{Z}} \big|_{\mathbf{Z}=\mathbf{Z}^{(k-1)}}$ Spatial Aggregation

$$\mathbf{Z}^{(k)} = \alpha \mathbf{X} + (1 - \alpha) \hat{\mathbf{A}}^{new} \mathbf{Z}^{(k-1)}$$

New Graph Structure: $\hat{\mathbf{A}}^{new} = \mathbf{I} - \gamma_{\theta}(\hat{\mathbf{L}}) = \mathbf{I} - \frac{\alpha}{1 - \alpha} (g_{\psi}(\hat{\mathbf{L}})^{-1} - \mathbf{I})$

Solution #4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

Desirable Properties on $\hat{\mathbf{A}}^{new} = \mathbf{I} - \frac{\alpha}{1 - \alpha} (g_{\psi}(\hat{\mathbf{L}})^{-1} - \mathbf{I})$

- Non-locality

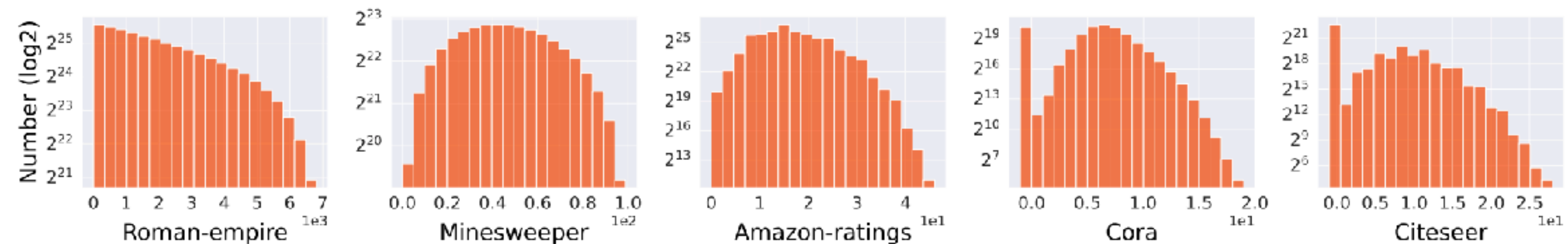


Figure 1: Distributions of connected nodes in the new graph based on their geodesic/shortest-path distance (as $\Delta_{i,j}$) in the original graph. Nodes, distant in the original graph ($\Delta_{i,j} > 1$ in x-axis), can be linked in the new graph (Number > 0 in y-axis).

- Signed edge weights reflecting “global node label relationships”

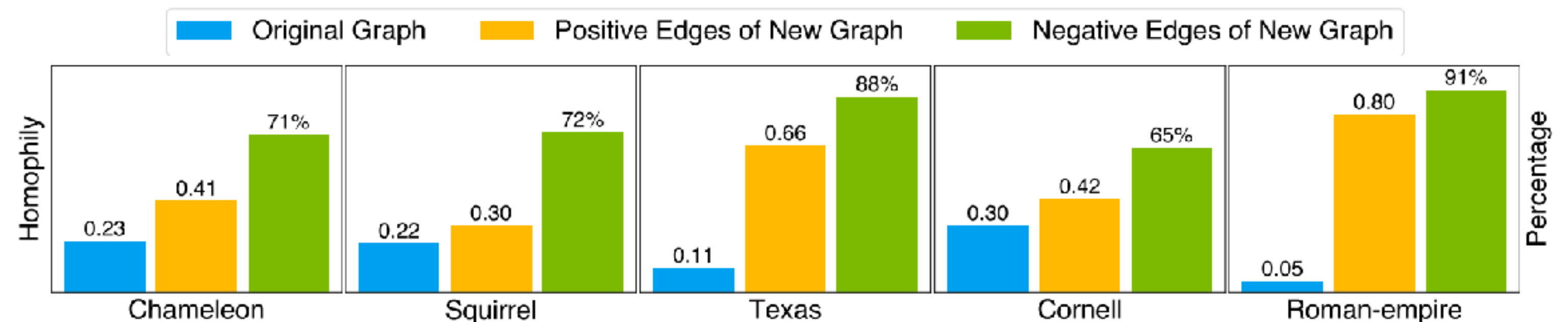


Figure 2: Left y-axis: Homophily comparison between original and new graphs, considering only positive edges (blue and yellow bars). Right y-axis: Percentage of edges connecting nodes from different classes, identified by negative edges (green bar).

Solution #4: Spatially-Guided Spectral Filtering

Overall Framework

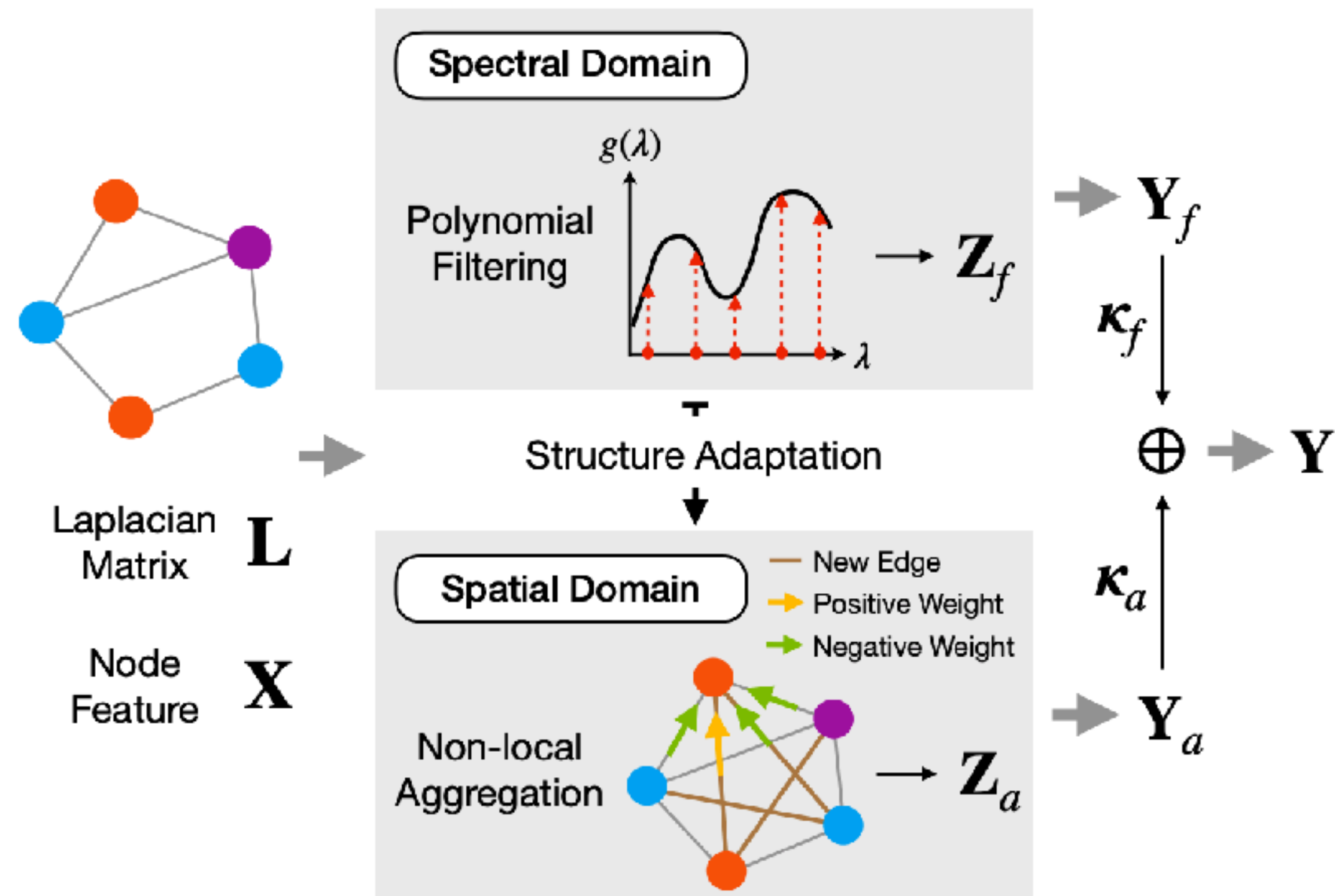
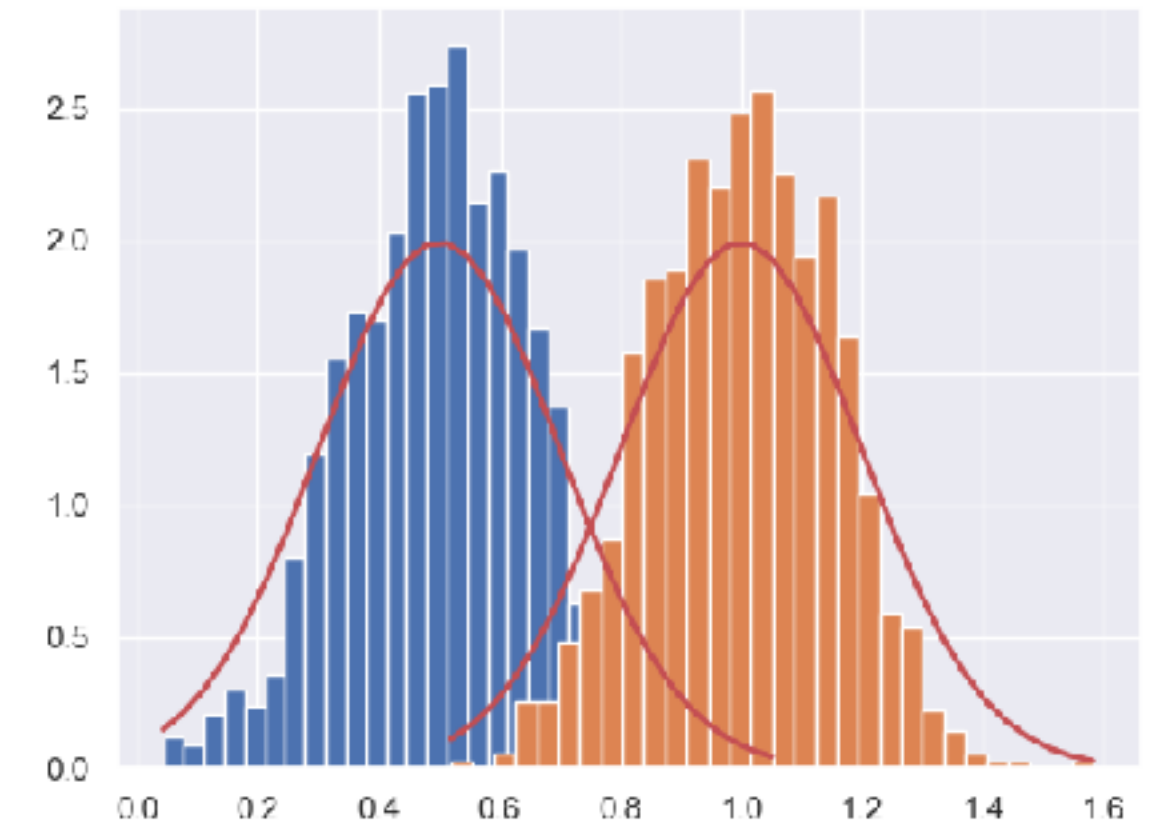


Figure 3: Illustration of the proposed SAF framework, where varying node colors represent different node labels.

Our method leverages the adapted new graph by spectral filtering for **non-local aggregation with signed edge weights**.

- Capture long-range dependency
- Address heterophilic graph links

Transfer Learning Under Distribution Shift



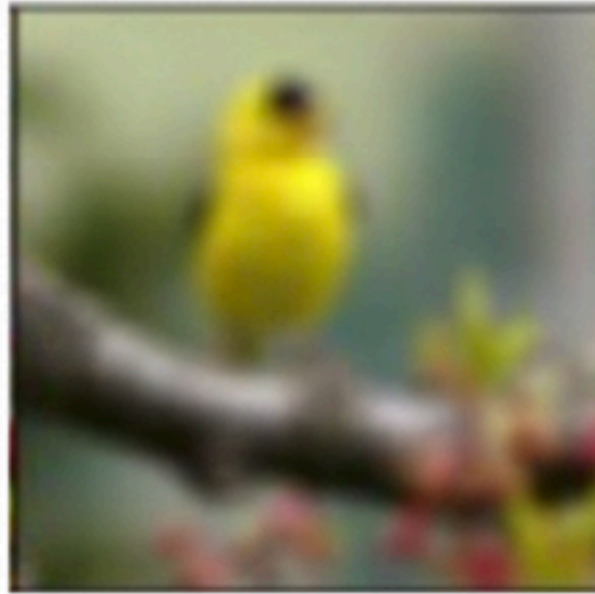
Research Background — Distribution / Covariate Shifts

Corruptions

Noise



Blur



Weather



Image styles

Photo



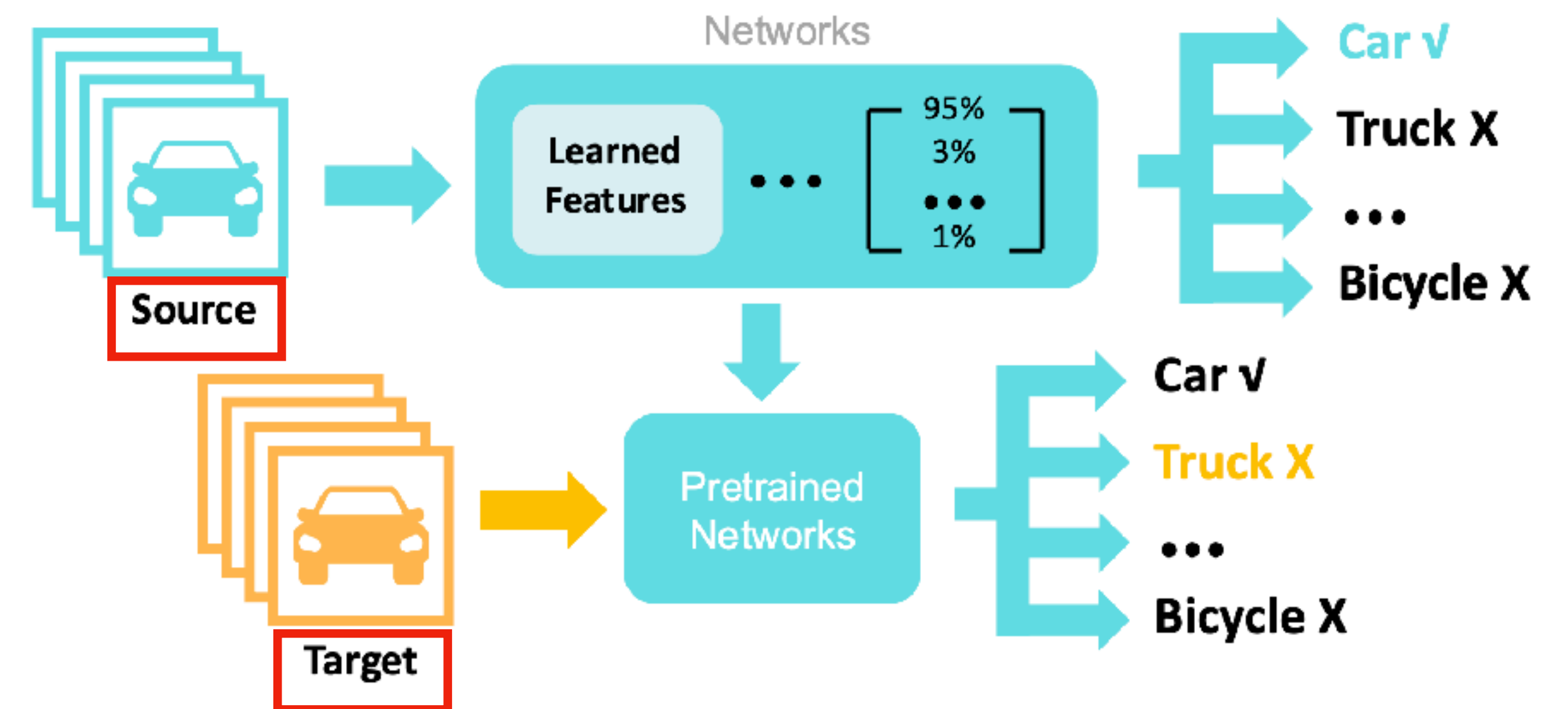
Art-painting



Cartoon



$$P_s(x) \neq P_t(x), P_s(y|x) = P_t(y|x)$$



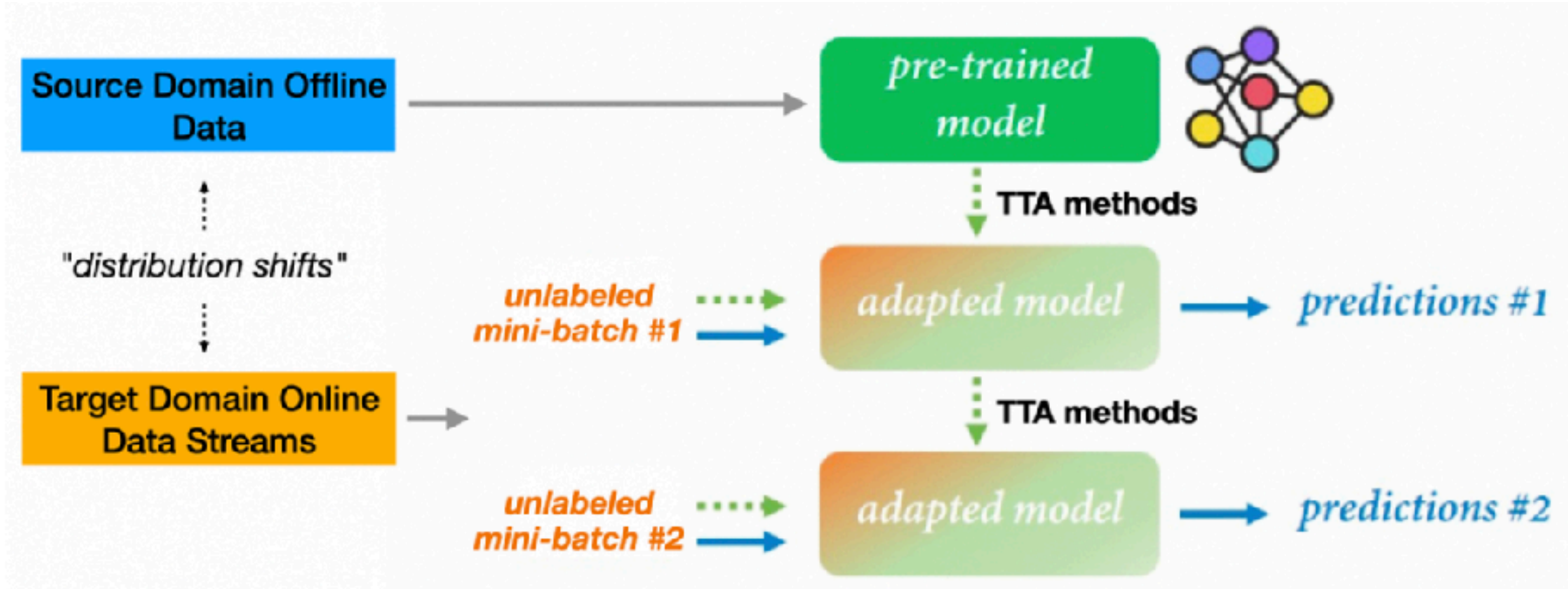
Distribution shift may cause model performance degradation.

Research Background — Test-time Adaptation (TTA)

TABLE I: Comparison of different transfer learning settings.

Topic	No Source Data*	No Target Labels*	Online Adaptation	Model Agnostic
Supervised Domain Adaptation	×	×	×	—
Unsupervised Domain Adaptation	×	✓	×	—
Source-free Domain Adaptation	✓	✓	×	—
Test-time Training	✓	✓	✓	×
Test-time Adaptation	✓	✓	✓	✓

Note: * denotes particular constraints during the adaptation process.



Given any pre-trained model, TTA aims to adapt it **at test-time towards the unseen and unlabeled data streams.**

Proposed Solutions x 3

**How to safeguard DL models
against distribution shifts?**

Sol#1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Sol#2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogenous Data Streams

Sol#3: Navigating Distribution Shifts in Media

Solution #1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

**How to safeguard DL models
against distribution shifts?**

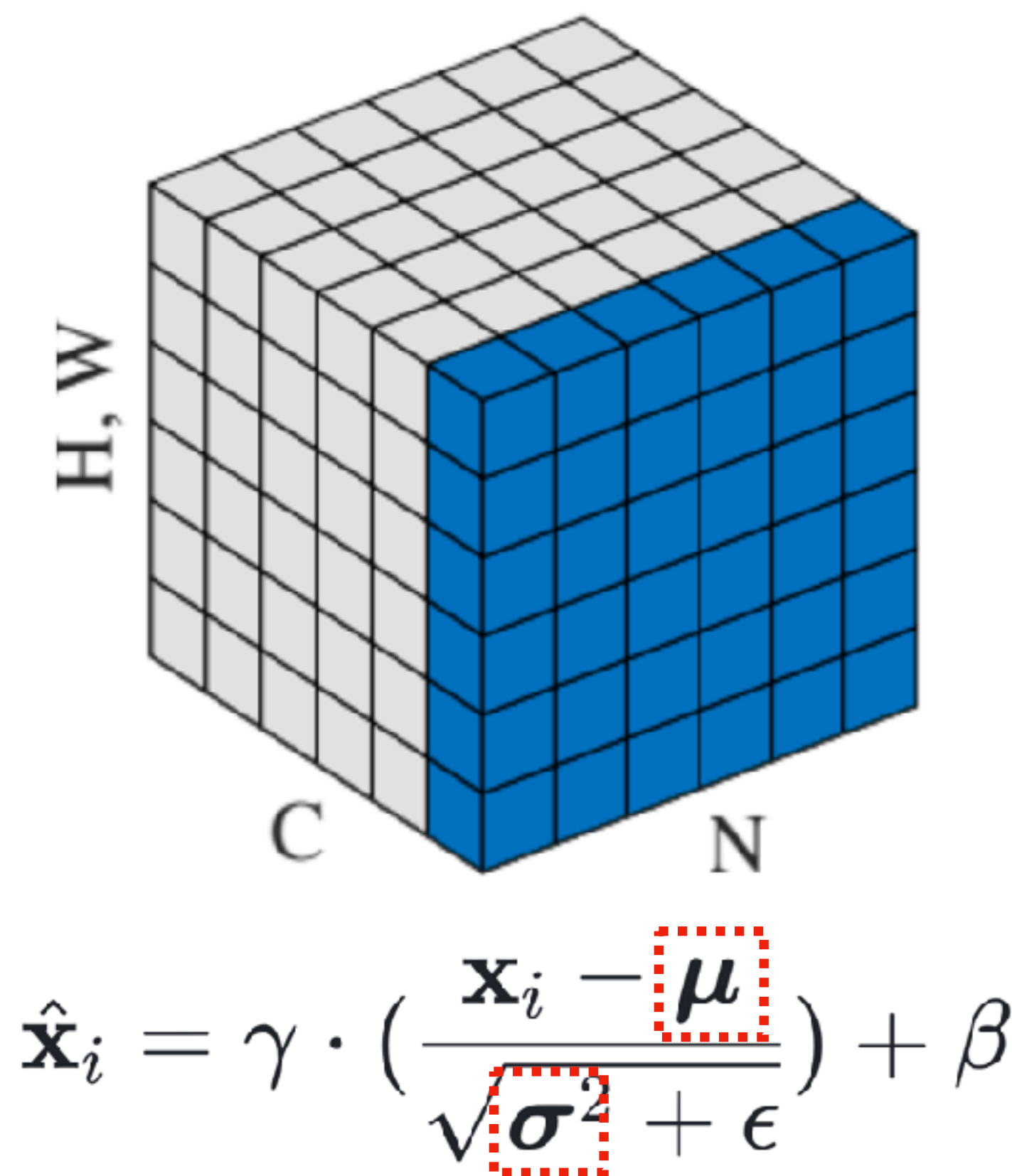
Sol#1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Sol#2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogenous Data Streams

Sol#3: Navigating Distribution Shifts in Media

Solution #1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Batch Normalization in Domain Adaptation



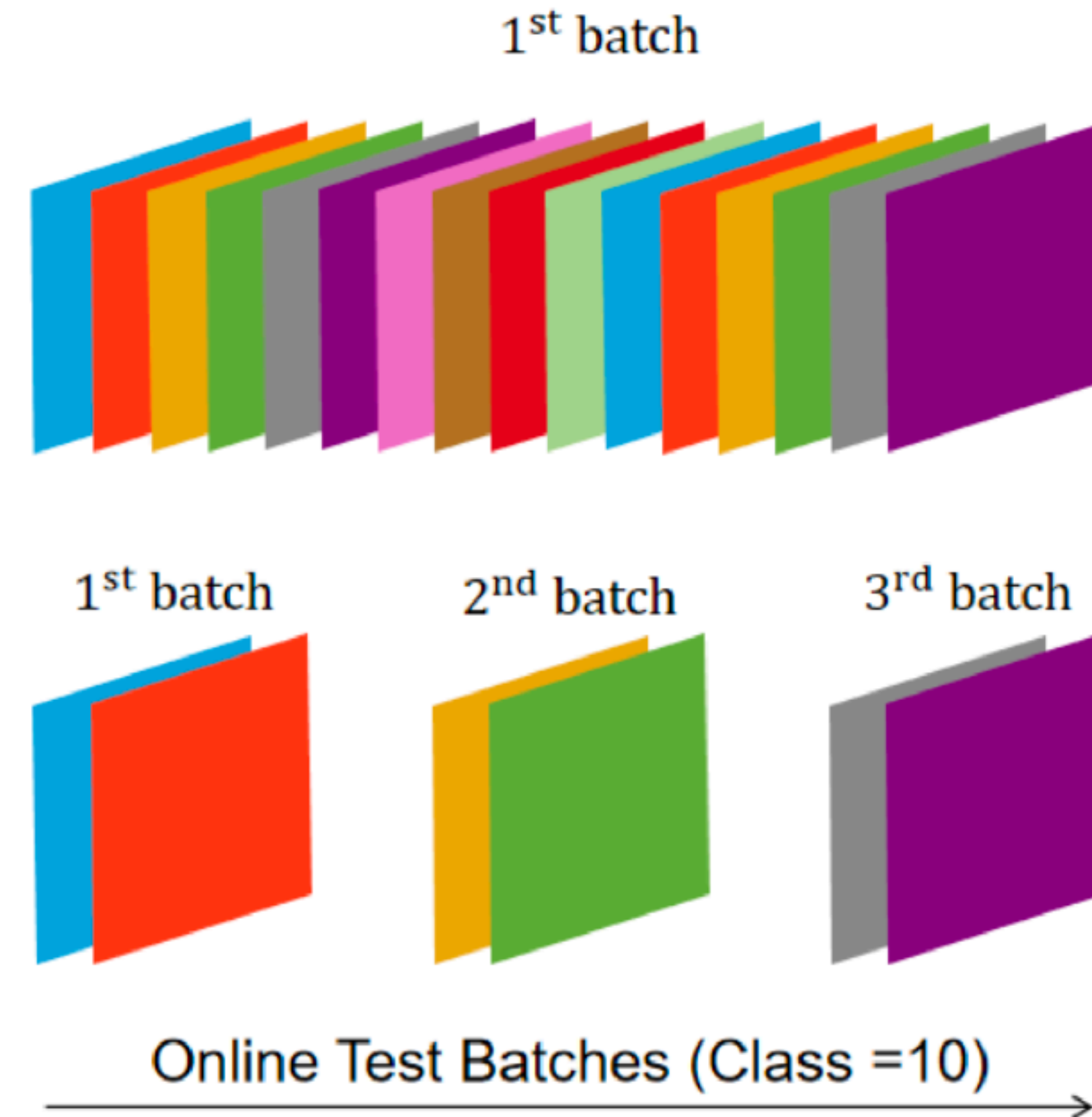
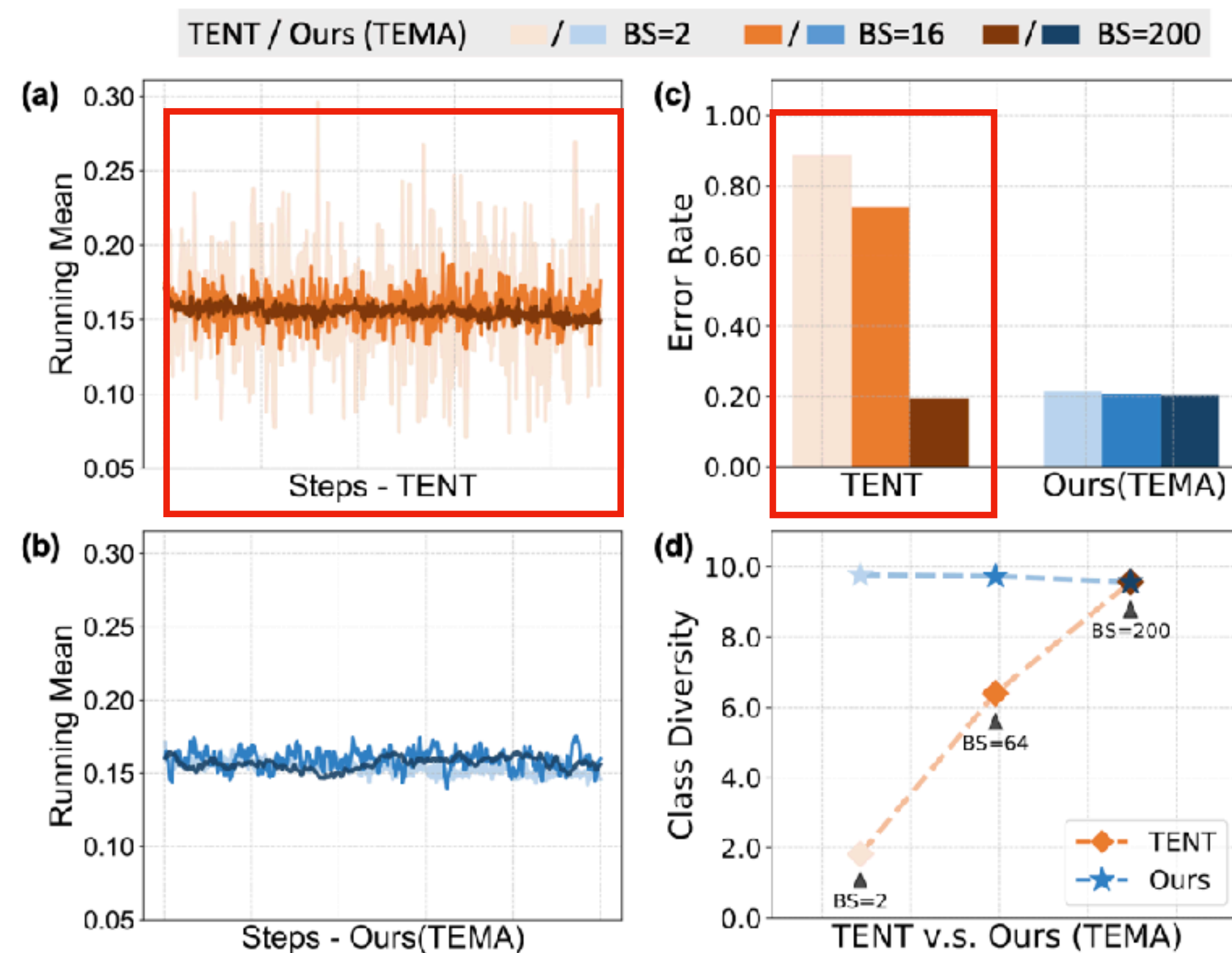
Parameters	How are they learned during training?	Testing
μ, σ	exponential moving average with momentum m : $\mu \leftarrow m\mu + (1 - m)\mu_b$ $\sigma^2 \leftarrow m\sigma^2 + (1 - m)\sigma_b^2$	Fixed
	$\mu_b = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N \mathbf{x}_i, \sigma_b^2 = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (\mathbf{x}_i - \mu_b)^2$	
γ, β	updated by gradients	Fixed

Normalization statistics are associated with **domain characteristics**.

Zixian Su, Jingwei Guo, et. al. Unraveling Batch Normalization for Realistic Test-Time Adaptation, AAAI 2024.

Solution #1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

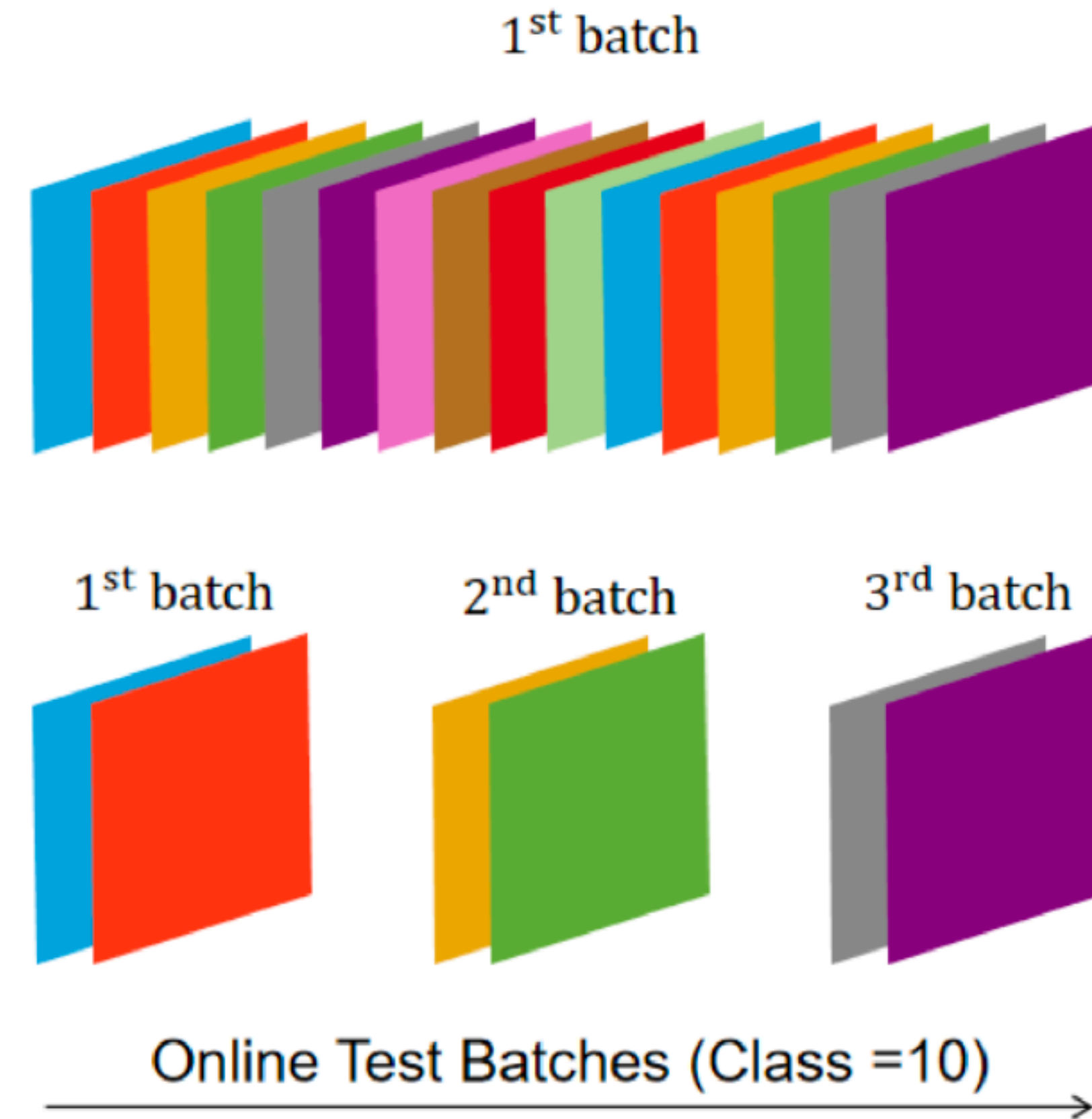
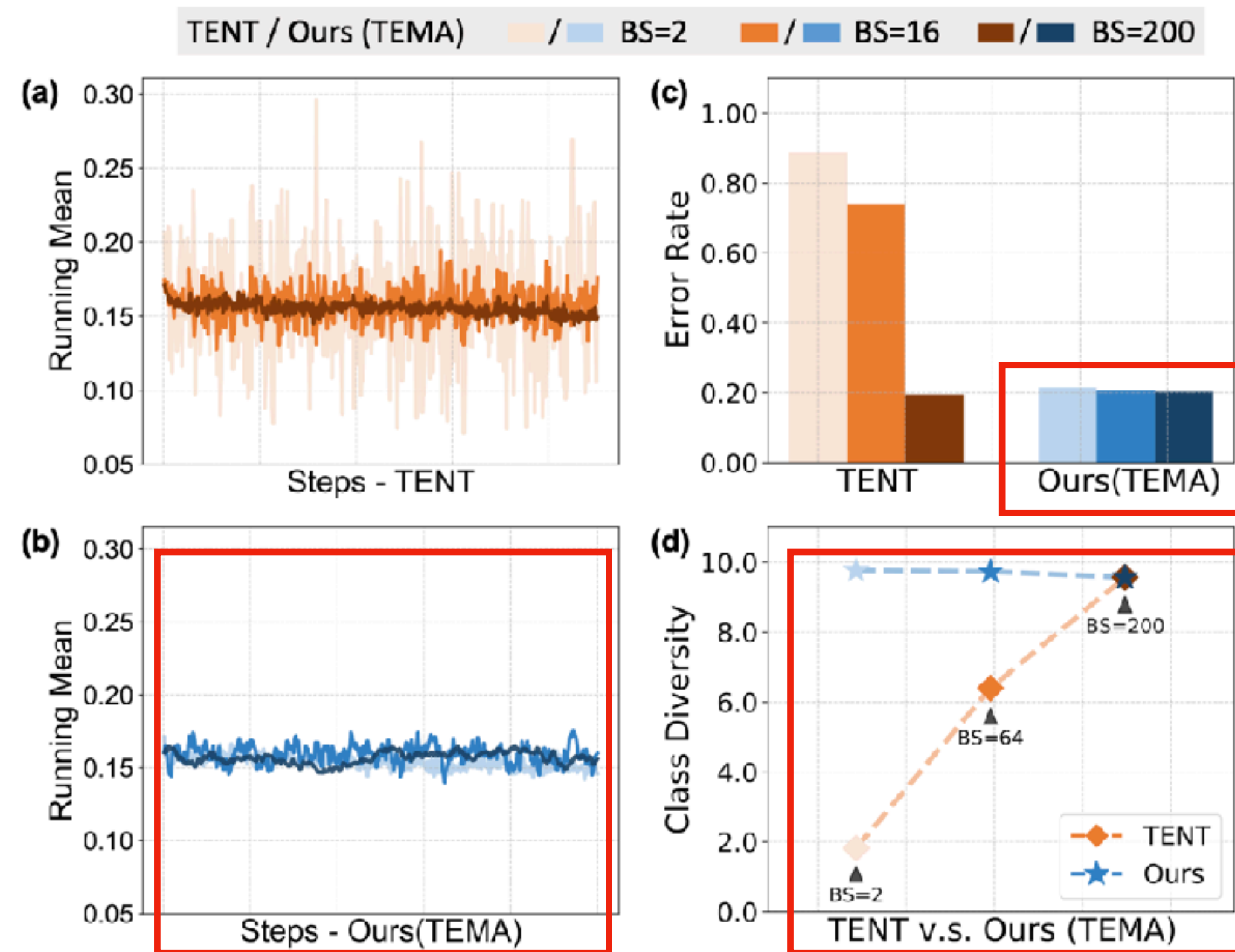
Small-batch Model Degradation



Traditional TTA methods tend to degrade on **small-batch data streams**.

Solution #1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Small-batch Model Degradation



TTA methods degrade on small batches due to **reduced class diversity**.

Solution #1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Exponential Moving Average at Test-time

$$\mu_t^{ema} = m \cdot \mu_t^{batch} + (1 - m) \cdot \mu_{t-1}^{ema}$$

$$\sigma_t^{ema2} = m \cdot \sigma_t^{batch2} + (1 - m) \cdot \sigma_{t-1}^{ema2}$$

- Larger m emphasizes local batches
- Smaller m prioritize global statistics

We apply grid search to tune m , guide by a tailored objective that balance local and global statistics.

Proposition 2. Given the iterative rules of TEMA defined in Eq. 3 and 4, it yields the i -th term as a cumulative sum of the past batch statistics weighted by $w_0 = (1 - m)^i$ for initial batch and $w_t = (1 - m)^{(i-t)}m$ for $t = 1, 2, \dots, i$. Let ϵ be a threshold defining the effective sample batch, such that only batches with a relative weight $w_t/w_i > \epsilon$ are included. Then, the expanded sample scope for statistical estimation in TEMA can be formally expressed as $\hat{N}_t = \lfloor \log_{1-m} \epsilon \rfloor \cdot N_t$.

$$\arg \min_m \left[\left| \frac{E(M_s | N_s)}{E(M_t | N_t)} - 1 \right| + \lambda \cdot \frac{N_t}{N_s} \right]$$

Aligning Class Diversity & Sample Scope

Solution #1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Empirical Results — Error Reduction

Continual		CIFAR-10-C							CIFAR-100-C						
		200	64	16	4	2	1	Avg.	200	64	16	4	2	1	Avg.
TR	Source	43.50	43.50	43.50	43.50	43.50	43.50	43.50	46.45	46.45	46.45	46.45	46.45	46.45	46.45
	TENT	19.55	26.32	74.07	85.07	88.69	90.00	63.95	61.12	86.49	96.07	98.40	98.79	99.00	89.98
	CoTTA	16.24	17.65	34.36	78.88	87.79	90.00	54.15	32.68	34.30	47.52	92.62	97.84	98.96	67.32
	SAR	20.40	20.74	22.89	31.35	40.32	89.83	37.59	31.90	35.89	54.84	66.08	73.24	98.91	60.14
	AdaCont.	18.50	17.41	19.69	35.01	63.81	31.55	31.00	33.61	35.40	55.04	89.45	96.16	62.67	62.06
	ETA	17.64	20.01	30.60	56.78	83.24	89.83	49.68	32.31	35.17	44.72	88.22	98.96	98.91	66.38
TF	TBN	<u>20.35</u>	20.82	23.06	31.62	38.57	89.83	37.38	35.50	36.29	39.67	52.73	73.24	98.91	56.06
	α -BN	30.60	30.67	30.89	31.89	32.91	<u>34.47</u>	31.91	37.02	38.27	<u>35.92</u>	37.17	<u>37.25</u>	<u>41.18</u>	37.80
	AdaptBN	20.36	<u>20.71</u>	<u>21.98</u>	<u>26.79</u>	<u>32.19</u>	37.52	<u>26.59</u>	<u>35.40</u>	35.78	<u>35.92</u>	<u>37.14</u>	39.23	41.85	<u>37.55</u>
	LAME	64.52	57.66	47.70	44.38	43.75	90.00	58.00	98.49	73.83	47.59	46.64	46.50	99.00	68.68
	Ours	20.20	20.57	20.74	21.45	20.91	21.05	20.82	34.63	<u>36.11</u>	35.31	36.02	36.32	39.30	36.28

Table 1: Continual adaptation on corruption benchmark CIFAR-10-C/CIFAR-100-C. Error rate ($\downarrow$) averaged over 15 corruption with severity level 5 for each test batch size (200/64/16/4/2/1).

Zixian Su, Jingwei Guo, et. al.Unraveling Batch Normalization for Realistic Test-Time Adaptation, AAAI 2024.

Solution #2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogeneous Data Streams

**How to safeguard DL models
against distribution shifts?**

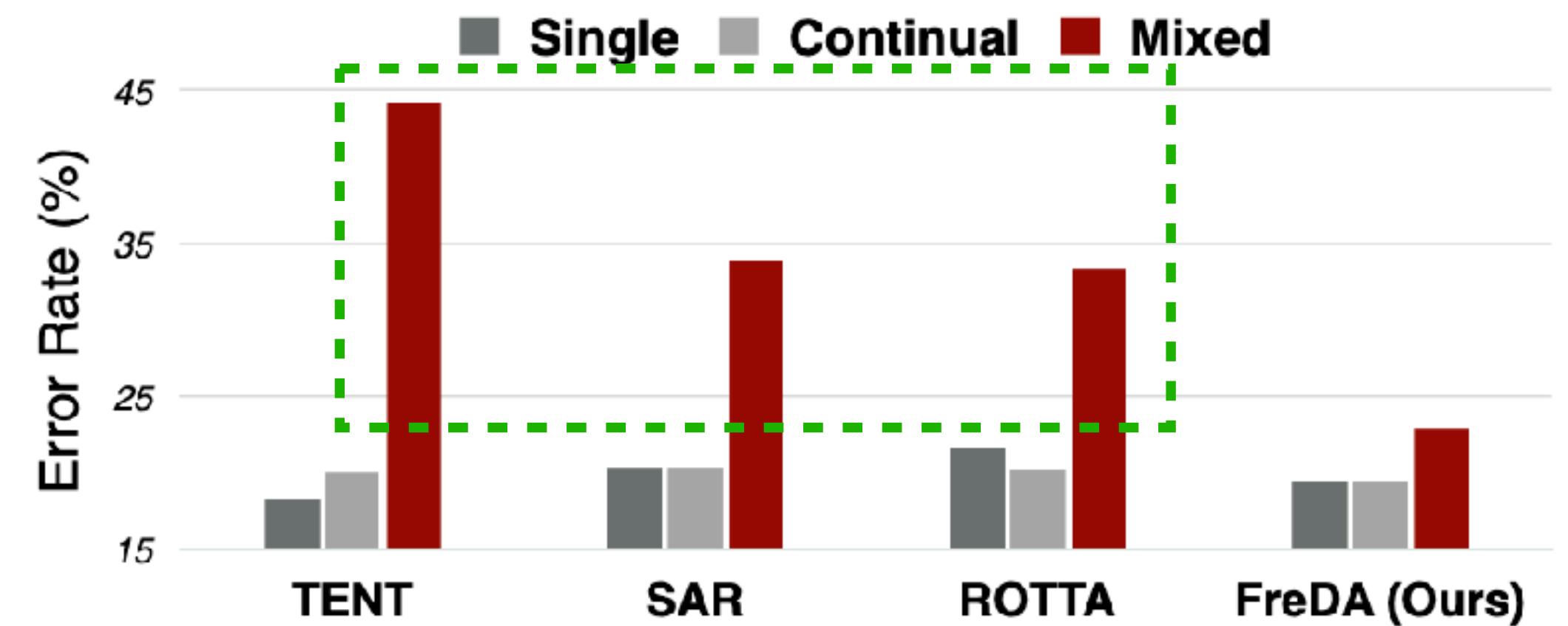
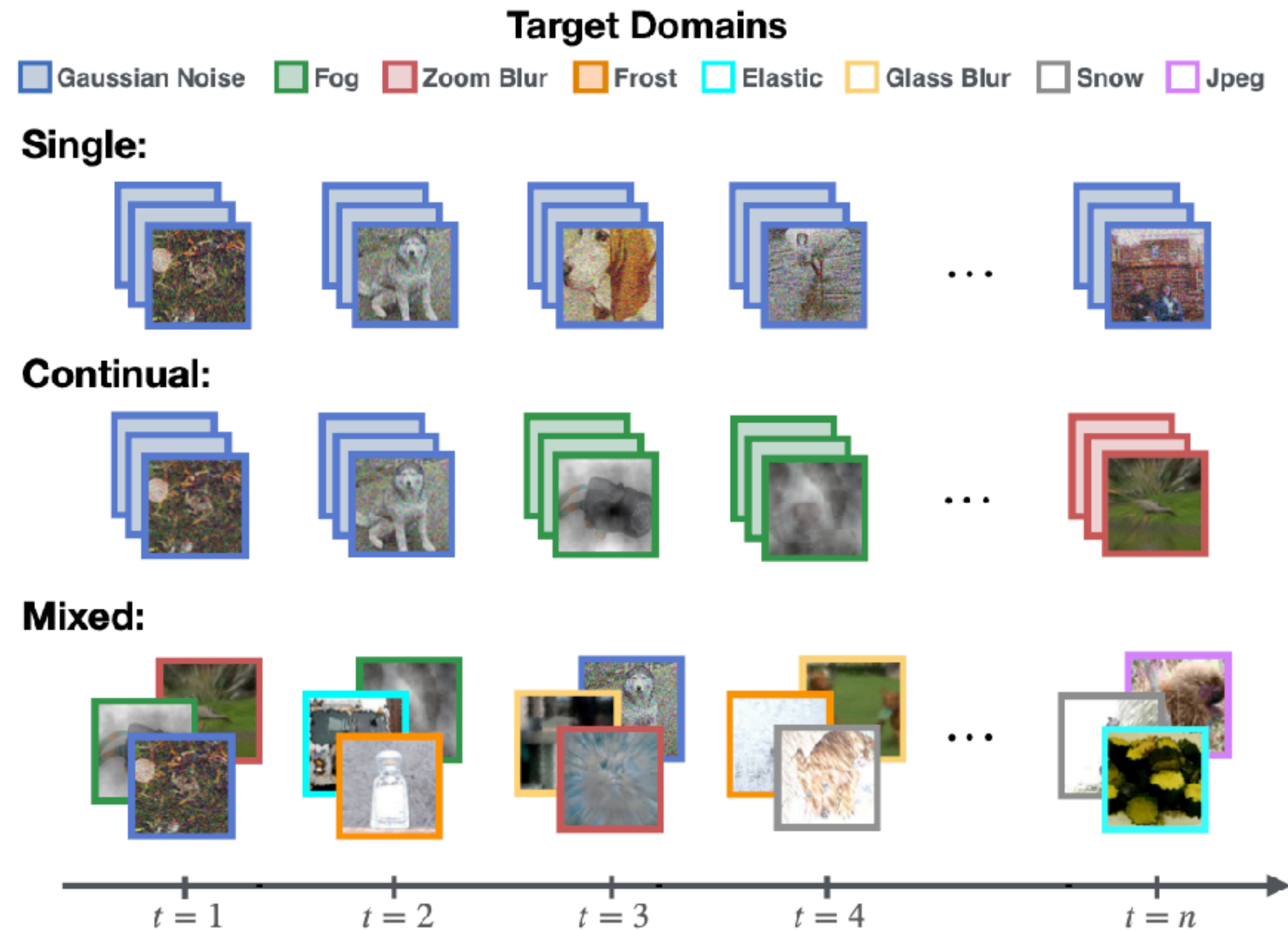
Sol#1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Sol#2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogenous Data Streams

Sol#3: Navigating Distribution Shifts in Media

Solution #2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogeneous Data Streams

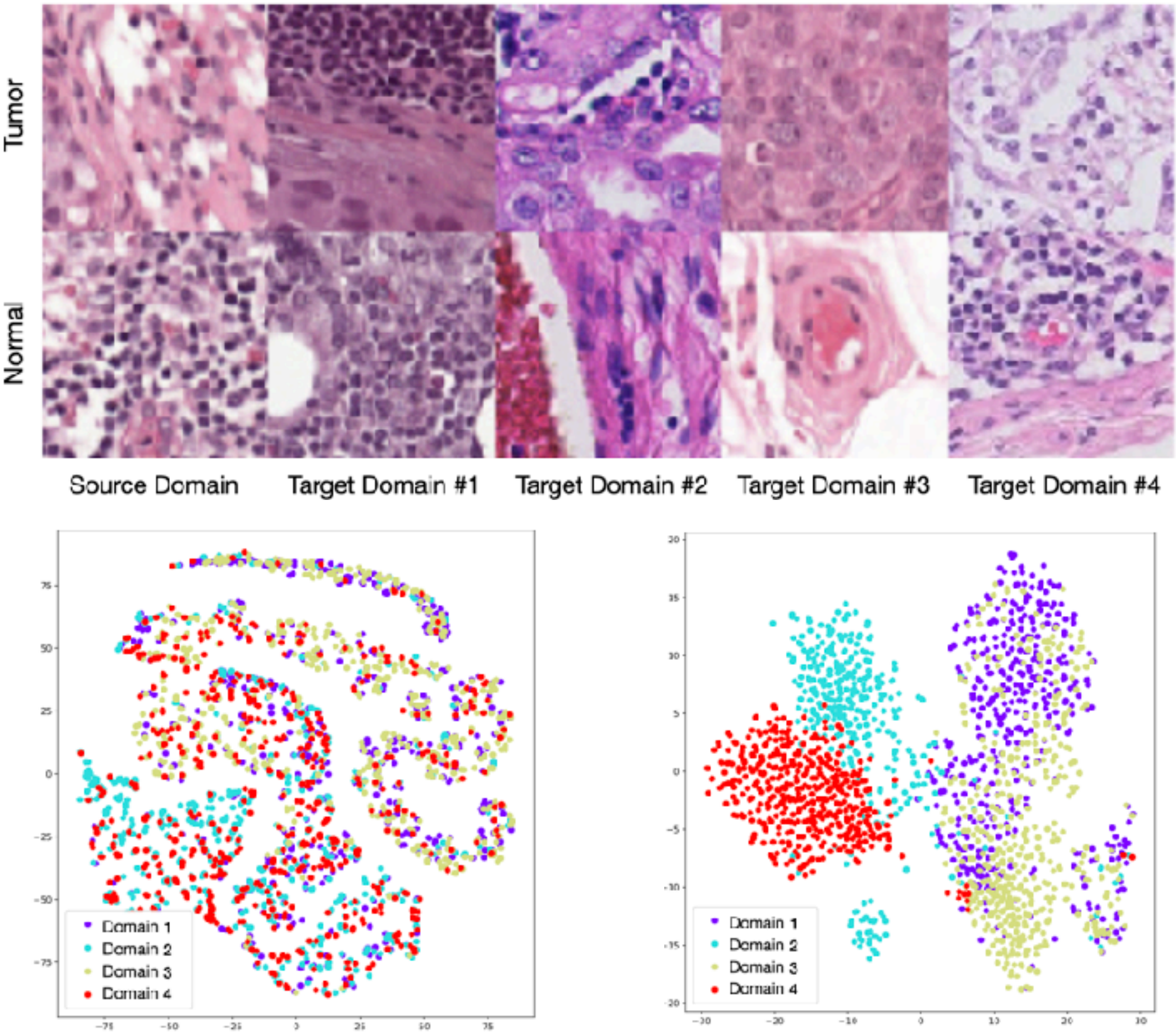
Heterogeneous / Mixed-domain Model Degradation



Conventional TTA methods assume homogenous data streams and employ **whole-batch adaptation strategies**.

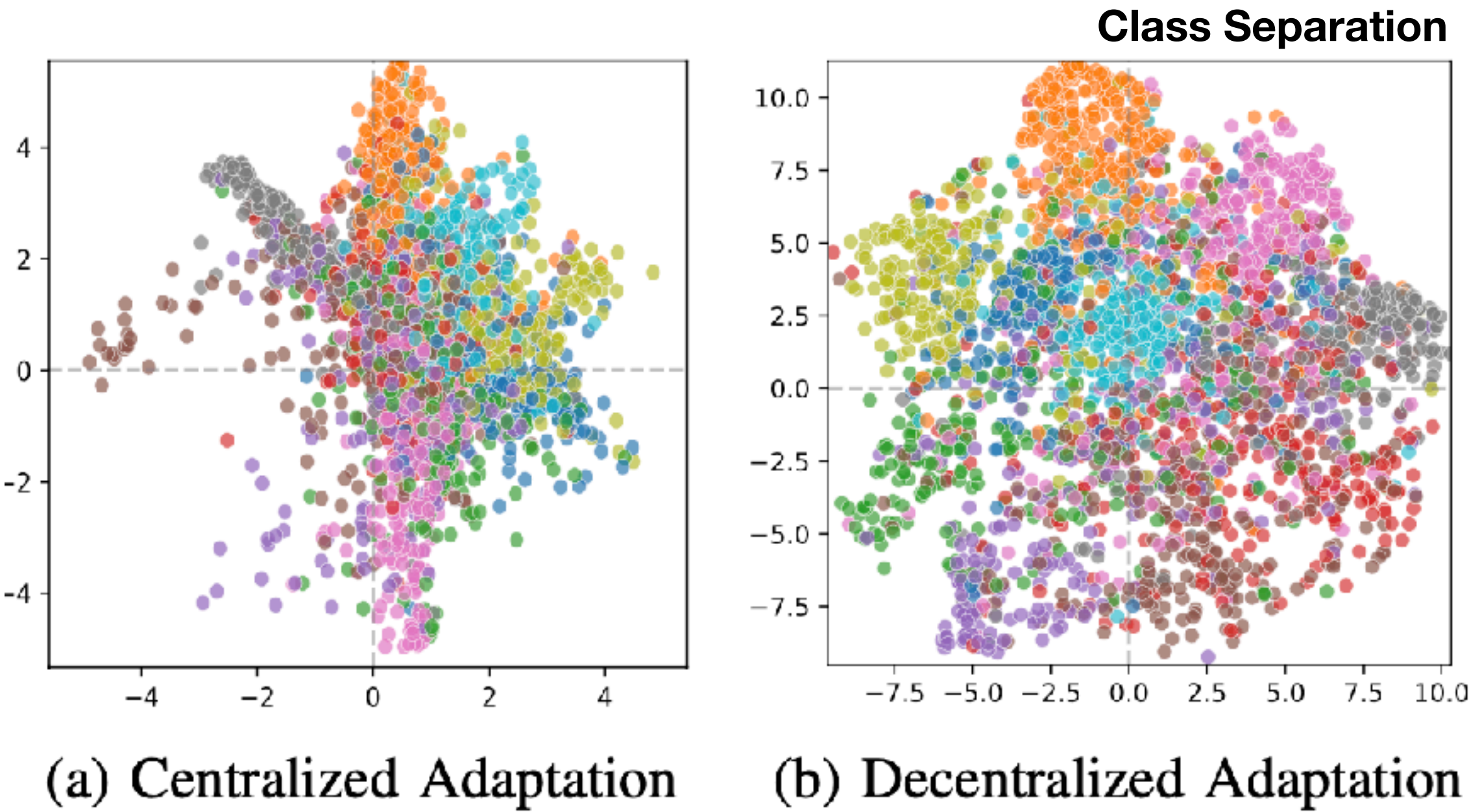
Solution #2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogeneous Data Streams

Frequency-based Domain Separation



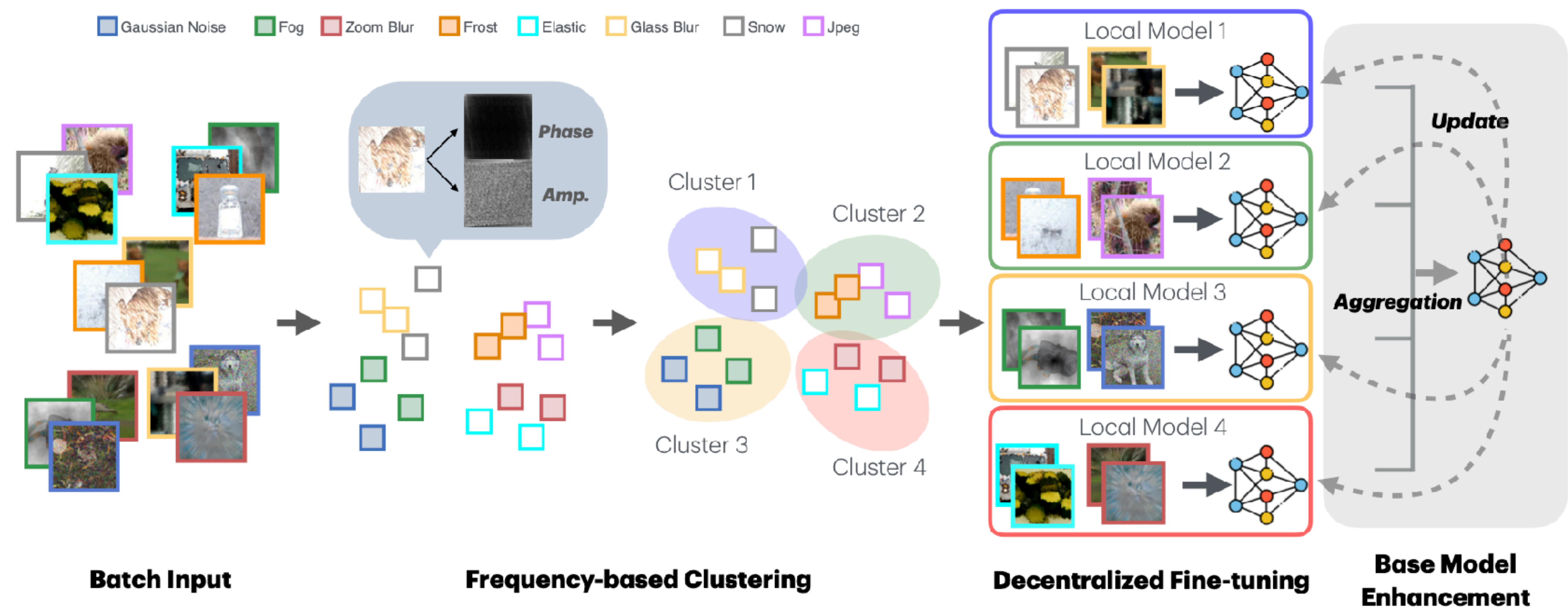
High-frequency information enable target subdomains' separation, contrasting with pre-trained model features.

Methods	Error rate (%)		
	C10	C100	IN
TBN (Centralized)	33.8	45.8	82.5
TBN (Decentralized)	28.5	43.2	77.6



Solution #2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogeneous Data Streams

Overall Framework



Zixian Su*, Jingwei Guo*, et. al., Un-mixing Test-time Adaptation under Heterogeneous Data Streams, *TKDE (Under Review)* 2025.

Solution #2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogeneous Data Streams

Empirical Results

Baseline & Methods	Gauss.	Shot	Impul.	Defoc.	Glass	Motion	Zoom	Snow	Frost	Fog	Brig.	Contr.	Elast.	Pixel	JPEG	Avg.
CIFAR-10-C (WRN-28)	72.3	65.7	72.9	46.9	54.3	34.8	42.0	25.1	41.3	26.0	<u>9.3</u>	46.7	26.6	58.4	30.3	43.5
TBN	45.5	42.8	59.7	34.2	44.3	29.8	32.0	19.8	21.1	21.5	<u>9.3</u>	27.9	33.1	55.5	30.8	33.8
TENT (ICLR 21')	73.5	70.1	81.4	31.6	60.3	29.6	28.5	30.8	35.3	25.7	13.6	44.2	32.6	70.2	34.9	44.1
ETA (ICML 22')	36.2	33.3	52.3	22.9	38.9	22.4	20.5	19.5	19.7	20.4	11.3	35.4	26.6	38.8	25.1	28.2
AdaContrast (CVPR 22')	36.7	34.3	48.8	18.2	39.1	21.1	<u>17.7</u>	<u>18.6</u>	<u>18.3</u>	<u>16.8</u>	9.0	17.4	27.7	44.8	24.9	26.2
CoTTA (CVPR 22')	38.7	36.0	56.1	36.0	36.8	32.3	<u>31.0</u>	<u>19.9</u>	<u>17.6</u>	<u>27.2</u>	11.7	<u>52.6</u>	30.5	<u>35.8</u>	25.7	<u>32.5</u>
SAR (ICLR 23')	45.5	42.7	59.6	34.1	44.3	29.7	31.9	19.8	21.1	21.5	<u>9.3</u>	27.8	33.0	55.4	30.8	33.8
RoTTA (CVPR 23')	60.0	55.5	70.0	23.8	44.1	<u>20.7</u>	21.3	20.2	22.7	16.0	9.4	22.7	27.0	58.6	29.2	33.4
RDumb (NeurIPS 23')	<u>34.9</u>	<u>32.3</u>	49.4	23.3	<u>38.2</u>	23.3	20.7	19.9	19.3	20.7	11.2	29.3	<u>26.7</u>	41.5	25.2	27.7
DeYO (ICLR 24')	45.8	42.3	65.7	21.3	41.8	25.1	19.5	21.1	19.6	19.2	12.3	21.8	28.5	39.3	28.0	30.1
UnMix-TNS (ICLR 24')	50.0	44.4	<u>44.3</u>	34.4	48.2	32.7	30.0	35.5	35.9	47.5	28.1	38.7	43.9	40.0	43.3	39.8
FreDA (ours)	23.1	22.2	32.2	<u>18.7</u>	41.6	18.8	16.8	17.9	19.9	16.9	9.8	13.2	29.1	35.4	28.6	22.9
CIFAR-100-C (ResNeXt-29)	73.0	68.0	39.4	29.3	54.1	30.8	<u>28.8</u>	39.5	45.8	50.3	29.5	55.1	37.2	74.7	41.2	46.4
TBN	62.7	60.7	43.1	35.5	50.3	35.7	34.4	39.9	51.5	27.5	45.5	42.3	72.8	46.4	45.8	45.8
TENT (ICLR 21')	95.6	95.2	89.2	72.8	82.9	74.4	72.3	78.0	79.7	84.7	71.0	88.5	77.8	96.8	78.7	82.5
ETA (ICML 22')	42.6	40.3	34.1	30.3	<u>42.4</u>	32.0	29.4	<u>35.6</u>	<u>35.8</u>	44.1	30.2	41.8	36.9	38.9	40.9	37.0
AdaContrast (CVPR 22')	54.5	51.5	37.6	30.7	<u>45.4</u>	32.1	30.3	<u>36.9</u>	<u>36.5</u>	45.3	28.0	42.7	38.2	75.4	41.7	41.8
CoTTA (CVPR 22')	54.4	52.7	49.8	36.0	45.8	36.7	33.9	38.9	<u>35.8</u>	52.0	30.4	60.9	40.2	<u>38.0</u>	41.1	43.1
SAR (ICLR 23')	75.8	72.7	41.1	29.2	45.2	<u>31.1</u>	28.9	36.7	<u>37.7</u>	43.9	29.3	41.8	<u>37.1</u>	<u>89.2</u>	42.4	45.5
RoTTA (CVPR 23')	65.0	62.3	39.3	33.4	50.0	34.2	32.6	36.6	36.5	45.0	26.4	41.6	<u>40.6</u>	89.5	48.5	45.4
RDumb (NeurIPS 23')	<u>42.3</u>	<u>40.0</u>	34.1	30.5	<u>42.4</u>	31.9	29.5	35.7	35.9	43.6	30.4	41.9	36.9	38.1	<u>40.5</u>	<u>36.9</u>
DeYO (ICLR 24')	57.2	53.4	38.8	34.7	47.3	37.3	34.1	40.8	40.5	50.6	33.3	45.8	41.5	94.5	45.7	46.4
UnMix-TNS (ICLR 24')	65.8	64.1	46.4	37.5	51.7	36.0	36.4	38.5	39.4	51.1	29.3	42.8	43.2	67.8	49.4	46.6
FreDA (ours)	34.8	34.7	<u>36.6</u>	<u>29.4</u>	41.2	29.9	28.4	33.8	33.7	<u>41.1</u>	29.8	34.9	36.9	37.1	38.7	34.7
IN-C (ResNet-50)	97.8	97.1	98.2	81.7	89.8	85.2	77.9	83.5	77.1	75.9	<u>41.3</u>	94.5	82.5	79.3	68.6	82.0
TBN	92.8	91.1	92.5	87.8	90.2	87.2	82.2	82.2	82.0	79.8	48.0	92.5	83.5	75.6	70.4	82.5
TENT (ICLR 21')	99.2	98.7	99.0	90.5	95.1	90.5	84.6	86.6	84.0	86.5	46.7	98.1	86.1	77.7	72.9	86.4
ETA (ICML 22')	90.7	89.2	90.5	<u>77.0</u>	80.6	<u>74.0</u>	<u>68.9</u>	<u>72.4</u>	<u>70.3</u>	<u>64.6</u>	43.9	93.4	69.2	52.3	55.9	<u>72.9</u>
AdaContrast (CVPR 22')	96.2	95.5	96.2	93.2	96.4	96.3	90.5	92.7	91.9	92.4	50.8	97.0	96.6	89.7	87.1	90.8
CoTTA (CVPR 22')	89.1	<u>86.6</u>	<u>88.5</u>	80.9	87.2	81.1	75.8	73.3	75.2	70.5	41.6	<u>85.0</u>	78.1	65.6	61.6	76.0
SAR (ICLR 23')	98.4	97.3	98.0	84.0	87.3	82.6	77.2	77.5	76.1	72.5	43.1	<u>96.0</u>	78.3	61.8	60.4	79.4
RoTTA (CVPR 23')	89.4	88.6	89.3	83.4	89.1	86.2	80.0	78.9	76.9	74.2	37.4	89.6	79.5	69.0	59.6	78.1
RDumb (NeurIPS 23')	89.0	87.6	88.6	78.1	82.3	75.2	70.1	73.0	71.0	65.1	43.9	92.6	<u>70.7</u>	<u>53.7</u>	<u>56.3</u>	73.1
DeYO (ICLR 24')	99.5	99.2	99.5	89.5	95.0	83.9	78.8	75.0	87.8	79.2	47.3	99.2	92.4	59.0	60.4	83.0
UnMix-TNS (ICLR 24')	91.7	92.8	91.7	92.3	93.4	91.5	84.8	86.3	84.1	85.0	62.0	96.5	88.6	81.7	77.3	86.7
FreDA (ours)	72.4	74.0	71.4	76.5	<u>82.3</u>	72.1	64.1	64.4	64.8	59.1	43.7	79.7	71.0	54.2	58.6	67.2

Error Rate -3.73%
under Mixed
Distribution Shifts

Solution #3: Navigating Distribution Shifts in MedIA: A Survey

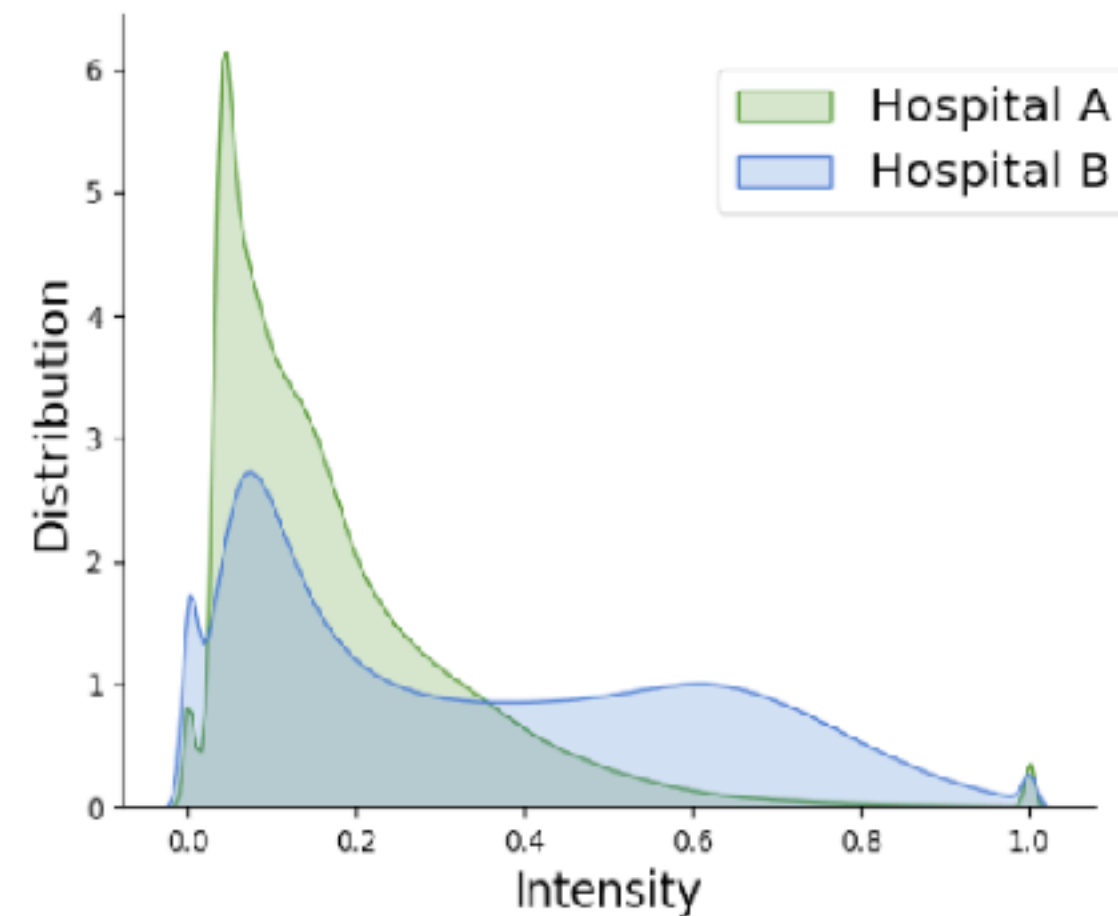
**How to safeguard DL models
against distribution shifts?**

Sol#1: Test-time EMA for Small-batch Data Streams

Sol#2: Un-mixing TTA for Heterogenous Data Streams

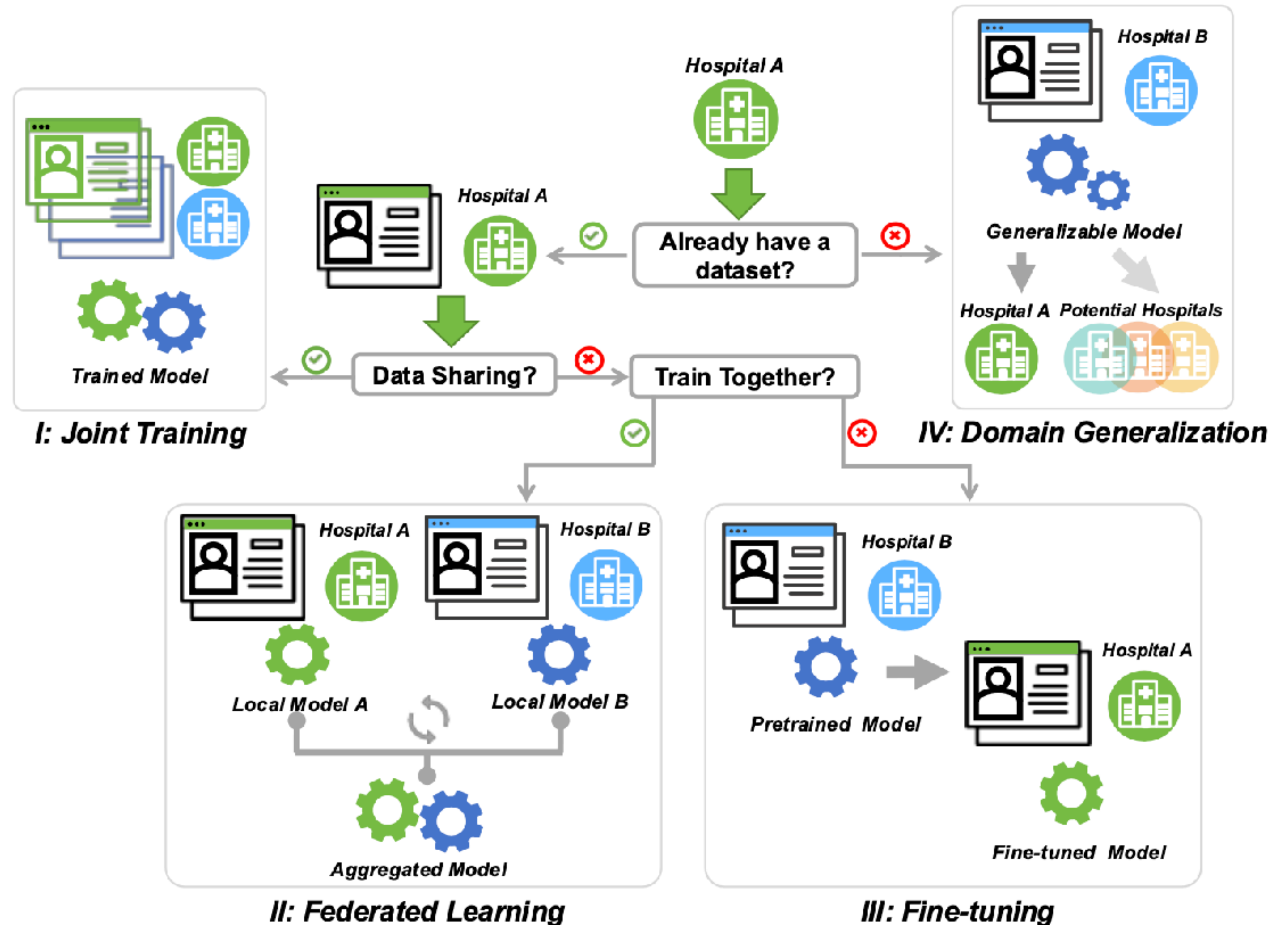
Sol#3: Navigating Distribution Shifts in MedIA

Solution #3: Navigating Distribution Shifts in MedIA: A Survey



Suppose **Hospital A (target)** seeks a model tailored for its distribution, developed in collaboration with **Hospital B (source)**:

- Data Accessibility
- Privacy Concerns
- Collaborative Protocols



Research Summary

